ENGLISH FOR WORK / ENGLISH FOR NAIL SERVICES

Nail Technician English

Precise details. Clear agreement.



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Eight practical lessons. Eleven extended conversations.
Vocabulary, phrase banks, guided speaking, and explained answers.

Revised 2026 edition / Upper-intermediate to advanced

Your route through the book

01 Clarifying the service and the intended length, page 4

Clarify the desired length before treating an ambiguous service label or reference photograph as an instruction.

02 Comparing shape and practical length, page 14

Compare sample silhouettes and lengths while preserving a practical requirement and avoiding unsupported durability claims.

03 Explaining color, coverage, and finish, page 26

Separate color, coverage, and finish while leaving an unspecified product system open for consultation.

04 Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote, page 35

Calculate a per-nail addition, offer complete priced alternatives, and confirm quantity and placement before starting.

05 Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns, page 47

Pause a cosmetic request, preserve the client report, and distinguish healthcare referral from salon service approval.

06 Giving a clear station-readiness update, page 57

Distinguish visible tidiness from completed readiness checks and offer a verified alternative without inventing a release time.

07 Handling a chip or design concern, page 70

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Hand over the desired appearance, unknown existing product, and pending consultation without inventing removal time or an infill booking.

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Suggested study range: B2-C1. This is an editorial study range, not a certified proficiency assessment.

Small details change the whole request.

A useful nail-service conversation separates length, shape, color, coverage, finish, product, design placement, price, and permission. Confirming those details prevents a familiar label or attractive reference from silently replacing what the client actually wants.

Describe before naming

A client may say full set while wanting no added length. Ask about the desired result before assuming that the service label or long reference image settles the request.
"You want the current short length retained; no extensions are requested."

Keep visual dimensions separate

Matte concerns shine, sheer concerns coverage, and pink concerns color. None of those words by itself identifies a product system or confirms that a particular service is suitable.
"Low shine and a visible nail line are the appearance preferences; product selection is still open."

Quote the whole option

When nail art is charged per nail, give the number of decorated nails and the total including the base service. A lower quantity should not become an unannounced reduction in the agreed design.
"Two decorated nails add $10 to the $30 base service, for a $40 total."

State the exact stage

A tidy station may still await required checks. A review is not a promised correction, a consultation request is not a booking, and a health referral does not approve a cosmetic service.
"Station two is confirmed ready; station three still has incomplete checks."

Professional boundaries

All clients, salons, prices, sample descriptions, and incidents are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not nail procedures, product removal, disinfection methods, medical diagnosis, treatment, or legal requirements. Follow professional training, current product instructions, actual salon procedures, applicable local rules, and emergency arrangements. Health concerns belong with an appropriate healthcare professional; cosmetic-service suitability requires its own salon assessment. No example authorizes covering an unexplained concern with product.

A Read the situation

LESSON 01 / CLARIFYING THE SERVICE AND THE INTENDED LENGTH

Clarify the desired length before treating an ambiguous service label or reference photograph as an instruction.

> **The picture is long; the request is short**
>
> Client Zoe booked an overlay but calls the appointment a full set when speaking to technician Lin. Zoe points to a long reference image, then explains that the current short length should be kept. No work has begun. Lin clarifies that the intended discussion is a natural-nail overlay without adding length, not automatically extensions. The image is a reference for the look, not permission to copy its length. Product choice, any further design details, and suitability still need the normal consultation.

People: Zoe, Client; Lin, Nail technician.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What length does Zoe want?

A. An unspecified amount added
B. The current short length retained
C. The full length in the photograph
D. A longer extension on every nail

2. What was booked?

A. A completed full set
B. An overlay
C. A confirmed extension service
D. A removal appointment only

3. What does the reference image authorize by itself?

A. Extensions on every nail
B. Any product the technician chooses
C. A guaranteed exact match
D. No automatic length change

Answers and explanations, page 104

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

natural nail
Client's own nail rather than an added enhancement.

identify the natural nail

nail plate
Hard visible part of the natural nail.

refer to the nail plate

nail bed
Tissue beneath the nail plate.

distinguish nail bed and plate

free edge
Part of the nail extending beyond its attachment at the fingertip.

discuss the free edge

overlay
Coating over a nail surface; the exact service needs clarification.

clarify the overlay

natural-nail overlay
Coating applied over the existing natural nail without necessarily adding length.

discuss a natural-nail overlay

extension
Added length beyond the existing natural nail.

confirm whether extensions are wanted

enhancement
Added material used to change nail appearance or structure.

clarify the enhancement

full set
Common service label whose intended scope must be confirmed.

clarify the full-set request

tip
Preformed component used in some nail-extension services.

identify an extension tip

form
Temporary support used in some sculpted-enhancement services.

distinguish a form from a tip

builder gel
Gel product category used to create enhancement structure.

discuss builder gel terminology

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

natural nail NATURAL NAIL

identify the natural nail

Keep the meaning precise: Client's own nail rather than an added enhancement.

natural-nail overlay NATURAL-NAIL OVERLAY

discuss a natural-nail overlay

Keep the meaning precise: Coating applied over the existing natural nail without necessarily adding length.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

acrylic
Common salon term for liquid-and-powder enhancement systems.
clarify the acrylic service

gel polish
Light-cured color-coating category, distinct from all enhancement services.
distinguish gel polish

lacquer
Conventional nail-polish category, distinct from gel polish.
identify nail lacquer

service label
Name used on a booking or menu.
clarify the service label

reference image
Picture used to discuss selected visual features.
interpret the reference image

retained length
Existing length the client wants to keep.
confirm retained length

added length
Extra length created by an extension service.
decline added length

current length
Length present before the proposed service begins.
check the current length

length preference
Client's stated choice about how long the result should be.
record the length preference

consultation
Discussion of the request, suitability, and proposed service.
complete the consultation

service scope
Specific work included in the agreed appointment.
confirm the service scope

read-back
Repetition of key details to verify understanding.
give a length read-back

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

builder gel BUILDER GEL

discuss builder gel terminology

Keep the meaning precise: Gel product category used to create enhancement structure.

reference image REFERENCE IMAGE

interpret the reference image

Keep the meaning precise: Picture used to discuss selected visual features.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Clarify the label

When you say full set, do you mean added length?

Ask about the result

Would you like to keep your current length?

Refer to the booking

Your booking currently says overlay.

Separate image and instruction

The photo shows long nails, but we should confirm your own length preference.

Confirm the practical choice

You want your current short length retained.

Explain the proposed term

We are discussing a natural-nail overlay without added length.

Keep extensions separate

No extensions are requested at this stage.

Avoid a product assumption

We have not selected the product system yet.

Check the visual feature

Which part of the image do you want to use as a reference?

Confirm before starting

No work has begun, so let us settle the details first.

Avoid embarrassment

Service names can be used differently; the result you want is what matters.

Distinguish scope

Adding length would be a different part of the service discussion.

Invite correction

Please correct me if short does not describe what you mean.

Keep assessment open

Suitability still needs the normal consultation.

Read back the request

Current short length, natural-nail overlay discussion, no extensions.

Close the clarification

The picture does not override your confirmed length preference.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Separate image and instruction
Useful wording: The photo shows long nails, but we should confirm your own length preference.

Purpose: Confirm the practical choice
Useful wording: You want your current short length retained.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which question resolves the key ambiguity?

A. Does full set always mean extensions?
B. Do you want added length, or your current short length kept?
C. Which payment method do you prefer?
D. Shall I copy the longest nail in the picture?

2. Which summary is accurate?

A. The reference authorizes an exact copy.
B. Natural-nail overlay discussion at current short length, with no extensions requested.
C. Long extensions confirmed from the image.
D. Product system selected by the word short.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Part of the nail extending beyond its attachment at the fingertip. Which term fits?

A. full set
B. free edge
C. length preference
D. lacquer

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The picture is long; the request is short". Zoe: "Good. I like the look in the photograph, but the long nails would get in my way at work." Lin: [missing response] Zoe: "So an overlay and extensions aren't the same thing? I'd like to know what the menu means next time." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Extensions add length. Here we're discussing material over the nail you already have, without adding to it.

B. Here's the read-back: natural-nail overlay discussion, current short length kept, no extensions. Product and suitability still need consultation.

C. Your booking says overlay. Do you want material over your existing nails, without adding length beyond them?

D. We'll use the reference image to discuss the look, not copy every feature. No extra length is requested.

Answers and explanations, page 104

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Overlay is a broad coating term, and full set can be used loosely. In this conversation, the client wants a natural-nail overlay at the current short length, with no extensions requested. Confirm the result before relying on either label.

E Conversation

The picture is long; the request is short

The picture is long; the request is short

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

overlay / nail plate / length preference / Builder gel / read-back / service label / product system / Extensions / reference image / retained length

01 **Zoe:** I'm here for a full set. I brought this picture, but please don't make them this long. I want to keep my own length.

02 **Lin:** Your booking says [1] _____. Do you want material over your existing nails, without adding length beyond them?

03 **Zoe:** Yes, that's what I meant. I heard someone call it a full set and assumed that was the right name.

04 **Lin:** That's fine. The [2] _____ can be used differently. Your short-length preference is more useful than guessing from the name.

05 **Zoe:** Good. I like the look in the photograph, but the long nails would get in my way at work.

06 **Lin:** We'll use the [3] _____ to discuss the look, not copy every feature. No extra length is requested.

07 **Zoe:** So an overlay and extensions aren't the same thing? I'd like to know what the menu means next time.

08 **Lin:** [4] _____ add length. Here we're discussing material over the nail you already have, without adding to it.

09 **Zoe:** And the hard part I can see is the nail plate? I've heard that called the nail bed too.

10 **Lin:** The [5] _____ is the hard visible part. The nail bed is the tissue underneath, so those terms aren't interchangeable.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The picture is long; the request is short

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Zoe:** That helps. What about builder gel and gel polish? I thought anything with gel in the name was the same service.

12 **Lin:** [6] _____ is used for enhancement structure. Gel polish is a color-coating category. We'll discuss which service is appropriate rather than treat them as synonyms.

13 **Zoe:** I haven't chosen a material yet. I'd like you to explain the options before we settle on one.

14 **Lin:** Certainly. The [7] _____ is still open. Keeping the nails short doesn't answer that question by itself.

15 **Zoe:** Please keep that short-length request on the booking. I don't want the picture confusing anyone else who helps today.

16 **Lin:** I'll record your [8] _____ clearly, along with no extensions requested. We can then continue with the other design details.

17 **Zoe:** Could you repeat the main point before we start? I want to be sure I explained it properly.

18 **Lin:** Here's the [9] _____: natural-nail overlay discussion, current short length kept, no extensions. Product and suitability still need consultation.

19 **Zoe:** Yes, that's right. I want the look discussed, not the long length copied.

20 **Lin:** Understood. That's the [10] _____ we'll work from. Nothing has begun, so we can clarify the remaining choices first.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. overlay / **2.** service label / **3.** reference image / **4.** Extensions / **5.** nail plate / **6.** Builder gel / **7.** product system / **8.** retained length / **9.** read-back / **10.** length preference

Why these answers fit, page 105

F Check accuracy and scope

The picture is long; the request is short

Return to the case

Client Zoe booked an overlay but calls the appointment a full set when speaking to technician Lin. Zoe points to a long reference image, then explains that the current short length should be kept. No work has begun. Lin clarifies that the intended discussion is a natural-nail overlay without adding length, not automatically extensions. The image is a reference for the look, not permission to copy its length. Product choice, any further design details, and suitability still need the normal consultation.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which product statement is supported?

A. Gel polish and every builder gel are the same.
B. Acrylic is required whenever a photo is long.
C. No consultation is needed for short nails.
D. Product selection still needs clarification.

2. Which response avoids blaming the client for terminology?

A. Full set means extensions here, so I will add length.
B. We can copy the photograph now and check your preference afterwards.
C. Service names vary; let us confirm the result you want.
D. Your booking says overlay, so I will ignore the picture.

Answers and explanations, page 106

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles and read the plate-versus-bed and builder-gel-versus-gel-polish exchanges with the definitions intact.

Check the meaning without correcting the person

Clients often learn service words from friends, menus, or social media, where the same label may be used differently. Ask what result they want, explain the relevant distinction plainly, and avoid making the client feel that knowing the salon vocabulary was a condition of asking.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Clarify another overlay request

A client shows a long reference but wants the existing medium length retained. The discussion is a natural-nail overlay with no extensions requested. Product choice is still open, and no work has begun.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

open / medium / extensions / begun

01 **Technician:** The current [1] _____ length should be retained.

02 **Client:** No [2] _____ are requested.

03 **Technician:** Product choice remains [3] _____.

04 **Client:** No work has [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. medium / **2.** extensions / **3.** open / **4.** begun

Why these answers fit, page 107

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The picture is long; the request is short". Zoe: "I haven't chosen a material yet. I'd like you to explain the options before we settle on one." Lin: [missing response] Zoe: "Please keep that short-length request on the booking. I don't want the picture confusing anyone else who helps today." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Your booking says overlay. Do you want material over your existing nails, without adding length beyond them?

B. We'll use the reference image to discuss the look, not copy every feature. No extra length is requested.

C. Certainly. The product system is still open. Keeping the nails short doesn't answer that question by itself.

D. Extensions add length. Here we're discussing material over the nail you already have, without adding to it.

Answers and explanations, page 108

A Read the situation

LESSON 02 / COMPARING SHAPE AND PRACTICAL LENGTH

Compare sample silhouettes and lengths while preserving a practical requirement and avoiding unsupported durability claims.

> **A shape that fits the working day**
>
> Client Amara likes a long almond sample but needs a short result for keyboard work. Technician Kai also has a short squoval sample, with a straighter free-edge outline and softened corners. The almond sample narrows toward a rounded tip and is visibly longer. Amara chooses the short squoval appearance for discussion. No method, exact measurement, or guarantee against breakage or discomfort is established. Kai must distinguish the visible comparison from a promise about how either shape will perform on the actual nails.

People: Amara, Client; Kai, Nail technician.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What practical requirement does Amara state?

A. A short result for keyboard work
B. The longest possible extension
C. A guaranteed unbreakable shape
D. A specified filing method

2. Which sample is short in this case?

A. The squoval sample
B. The almond sample
C. Both are described as long
D. Neither sample has a length

3. What does Amara choose for discussion?

A. An unassessed extension method
B. The short squoval appearance
C. A guaranteed damage-proof result
D. The exact long almond sample

Answers and explanations, page 109

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

silhouette
Outer visible outline of a nail shape.

compare the silhouettes

almond
Shape narrowing toward a rounded, almond-like tip.

describe the almond sample

squoval
Shape combining a straighter edge with softened corners.

explain the squoval outline

square
Shape with a straighter free edge and more defined corners.

identify the square shape

round
Shape with a rounded free-edge outline.

compare a round shape

oval
Elongated rounded shape without a sharply pointed tip.

describe an oval outline

stiletto
Shape narrowing to a pronounced pointed tip.

identify the stiletto sample

coffin
Tapered shape ending in a comparatively flat tip.

describe the coffin silhouette

tapered sides
Side outlines that narrow toward the tip.

compare tapered sides

rounded tip
Tip with a curved rather than sharp endpoint.

identify the rounded tip

softened corners
Corners with a gentler rounded outline.

describe softened corners

straight edge
Outline appearing relatively flat across the end.

identify the straight edge

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

silhouette SILHOUETTE

compare the silhouettes

Keep the meaning precise: Outer visible outline of a nail shape.

oval OVAL

describe an oval outline

Keep the meaning precise: Elongated rounded shape without a sharply pointed tip.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

sample display
Set of examples used to compare visible choices.
use the sample display

length reference
Agreed example or measurement used to discuss length.
confirm a length reference

practical requirement
Everyday need affecting the client's preference.
record the practical requirement

keyboard work
Work involving regular typing or use of keys.
discuss keyboard work

daily use
How the client normally uses their hands.
ask about daily use

preferred outline
Shape the client selects for discussion.
confirm the preferred outline

symmetry
Visual balance between corresponding sides or nails.
discuss symmetry

proportion
Relationship between dimensions such as length and width.
compare proportions

breakage
Breaking of a nail or enhancement, not prevented by a verbal guarantee.
avoid a breakage guarantee

comfort expectation
What the client hopes will feel manageable in use.
clarify the comfort expectation

measurement
Specific quantified length, not established by a broad label alone.
agree on a measurement

suitability assessment
Professional review of whether the proposed service fits the actual situation.
complete a suitability assessment

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

straight edge STRAIGHT EDGE

identify the straight edge

Keep the meaning precise: Outline appearing relatively flat across the end.

daily use DAILY USE

ask about daily use

Keep the meaning precise: How the client normally uses their hands.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Ask about daily use

What length feels practical for your keyboard work?

Acknowledge the attraction

You like the almond outline in this sample.

Identify the conflict

This particular almond sample is longer than your stated preference.

Describe the alternative

The squoval sample shown here is short.

Explain the corners

It has a straighter edge with softened corners.

Explain the almond tip

The almond sample narrows toward a rounded tip.

Separate shape and length

Let us compare the outline and the length as two details.

Preserve the practical limit

Your priority is a short result.

Avoid a durability promise

I cannot promise that either shape prevents breakage.

Avoid a comfort guarantee

The sample alone cannot establish how it will feel in daily use.

Check the chosen appearance

Is the short squoval sample closer to what you want?

Leave the method open

We have not agreed on a technical method yet.

Confirm a reference

We still need a clear length reference for your actual nails.

Keep the comparison neutral

The shapes look different; neither is automatically better for everyone.

Read back the priority

Short length for keyboard work, with the squoval appearance preferred.

Confirm before proceeding

We will settle the remaining details before starting.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Describe the alternative
Useful wording: The squoval sample shown here is short.

Purpose: Explain the corners
Useful wording: It has a straighter edge with softened corners.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which comparison is accurate?

A. This almond sample is long and tapered; this squoval sample is short with softened corners.
B. Every almond nail has the same length.
C. Squoval guarantees no breakage.
D. The short sample proves every service is suitable.

2. Which question best clarifies the next detail?

A. Shall I assume the long sample overrides your work needs?
B. Do you accept a guaranteed unbreakable result?
C. Can we skip the consultation because the sample is short?
D. What length reference shall we agree on for your actual nails?

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Shape with a straighter free edge and more defined corners. Which term fits?

A. practical requirement
B. square
C. breakage
D. tapered sides

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A shape that fits the working day". Amara: "What is the name of the shorter one beside it? The end looks straighter, but the corners do not look sharply square." Kai: [missing response] Amara: "I think the shorter one is closer. Could we use that shape without copying the long sample?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The almond outline narrows toward a rounded tip. In this particular sample, that outline is shown at a visibly longer length.

B. Certainly. We are comparing the silhouettes and lengths first. The technical method and the appropriate service still need their own discussion.

C. That is the squoval sample. It combines a straighter end with softened corners, and the example here is short.

D. I will. Softened corners are part of the visible shape you prefer, separate from the exact length we still need to confirm.

Answers and explanations, page 109

> **One useful distinction**
>
> This comparison concerns the two supplied samples: long almond and short squoval. Squoval describes an outline, not an absolute length in every salon. The selected short appearance still needs an agreed length reference and normal assessment.

E Conversation

A shape that fits the working day

A shape that fits the working day

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

preferred outline / practical requirement / squoval / breakage / comfort guarantee / silhouettes / length reference / Softened corners / almond / suitability assessment

01 **Amara:** I like this almond sample, but it looks much longer than I could manage at work. I spend most of the day using a keyboard.

02 **Kai:** The [1] _____ is a short result, then. We can compare the shape you like without assuming you want the full length of this display sample.

03 **Amara:** Yes. I like the tapered shape, but that length would make typing awkward for me.

04 **Kai:** The [2] _____ outline narrows toward a rounded tip. In this particular sample, that outline is shown at a visibly longer length.

05 **Amara:** What is the name of the shorter one beside it? The end looks straighter, but the corners do not look sharply square.

06 **Kai:** That is the [3] _____ sample. It combines a straighter end with softened corners, and the example here is short.

07 **Amara:** I think the shorter one is closer. Could we use that shape without copying the long sample?

08 **Kai:** Certainly. We are comparing the [4] _____ and lengths first. The technical method and the appropriate service still need their own discussion.

09 **Amara:** The shorter one seems less likely to get in my way. Does that mean it will definitely be comfortable when I type?

10 **Kai:** I cannot give a [5] _____ from a sample. Your work needs help guide the consultation, but they do not prove how a particular result will feel on your actual nails.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A shape that fits the working day

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Amara:** Does squoval mean it won't break? A friend told me it was the strongest shape.

12 **Kai:** A [6] _____ promise like that would be too strong. We can discuss your preferences and the assessment without claiming a shape is unbreakable.

13 **Amara:** Then let us use the short squoval as the appearance I prefer. I do not want the long almond length copied.

14 **Kai:** I will record the [7] _____ and your short-length priority together. That keeps the visual choice connected to the practical reason you gave.

15 **Amara:** How short do you mean on my nails? Could you show me before you start?

16 **Kai:** Yes, we still need an agreed [8] _____ for your actual nails. The word short is useful, but it should not be the only detail in the final agreement.

17 **Amara:** Good. Please keep the softened corners in the discussion too. That is part of what I like about the second sample.

18 **Kai:** I will. [9] _____ are part of the visible shape you prefer, separate from the exact length we still need to confirm.

19 **Amara:** Yes, short with those softer corners. Let's check the actual length together.

20 **Kai:** Correct. The [10] _____ and remaining details still matter. We have a clear direction: short length for keyboard work, with the squoval appearance preferred.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. practical requirement / **2.** almond / **3.** squoval / **4.** silhouettes / **5.** comfort guarantee / **6.** breakage / **7.** preferred outline / **8.** length reference / **9.** Softened corners / **10.** suitability assessment

Why these answers fit, page 110

F Check accuracy and scope

A shape that fits the working day

Return to the case

Client Amara likes a long almond sample but needs a short result for keyboard work. Technician Kai also has a short squoval sample, with a straighter free-edge outline and softened corners. The almond sample narrows toward a rounded tip and is visibly longer. Amara chooses the short squoval appearance for discussion. No method, exact measurement, or guarantee against breakage or discomfort is established. Kai must distinguish the visible comparison from a promise about how either shape will perform on the actual nails.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which promise is unsupported?

A. No method has been agreed yet.
B. This shape will never cause discomfort or break.
C. The squoval sample has softened corners.
D. You prefer short length for keyboard work.

2. What does the selected sample establish?

A. An exact universal measurement
B. An approved technical procedure
C. A guarantee for every daily task
D. A preferred appearance for discussion

Answers and explanations, page 112

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Read the keyboard-work request without turning the client's preference into a guarantee against breakage.

A practical preference is not a lesser choice

Avoid praising one shape as universally better or more professional. Ask how the client uses their hands, compare the supplied samples neutrally, and preserve the stated length limit. The client should not feel pressured to copy a dramatic display sample.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Separate shape from a guarantee

A client compares a long oval sample with a short round sample. They choose the short round appearance for keyboard work. No exact measurement or guarantee against breakage is agreed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

round / measurement / breakage / short

01 **Technician:** The preferred shape is [1] _____.

02 **Client:** My practical priority is [2] _____ length.

03 **Technician:** The exact [3] _____ still needs agreement.

04 **Client:** No guarantee against [4] _____ has been made.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. round / **2.** short / **3.** measurement / **4.** breakage

Why these answers fit, page 112

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A shape that fits the working day". Amara: "Then let us use the short squoval as the appearance I prefer. I do not want the long almond length copied." Kai: [missing response] Amara: "How short do you mean on my nails? Could you show me before you start?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. A breakage promise like that would be too strong. We can discuss your preferences and the assessment without claiming a shape is unbreakable.

B. I will record the preferred outline and your short-length priority together. That keeps the visual choice connected to the practical reason you gave.

C. I will. Softened corners are part of the visible shape you prefer, separate from the exact length we still need to confirm.

D. Correct. The suitability assessment and remaining details still matter. We have a clear direction: short length for keyboard work, with the squoval appearance preferred.

Answers and explanations, page 113

Review 1 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Clarifying the service and the intended length" and "Comparing shape and practical length". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Tissue beneath the nail plate. Which term fits?

A. enhancement
B. nail bed
C. gel polish
D. current length

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Tapered shape ending in a comparatively flat tip. Which term fits?

A. silhouette
B. sample display
C. coffin
D. symmetry

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The picture is long; the request is short". Zoe: "And the hard part I can see is the nail plate? I've heard that called the nail bed too." Lin: [missing response] Zoe: "That helps. What about builder gel and gel polish? I thought anything with gel in the name was the same service." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The nail plate is the hard visible part. The nail bed is the tissue underneath, so those terms aren't interchangeable.
B. I'll record your retained length clearly, along with no extensions requested. We can then continue with the other design details.
C. Understood. That's the length preference we'll work from. Nothing has begun, so we can clarify the remaining choices first.
D. That's fine. The service label can be used differently. Your short-length preference is more useful than guessing from the name.

Review 1 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A shape that fits the working day". Amara: "Good. Please keep the softened corners in the discussion too. That is part of what I like about the second sample." Kai: [missing response] Amara: "Yes, short with those softer corners. Let's check the actual length together." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. A breakage promise like that would be too strong. We can discuss your preferences and the assessment without claiming a shape is unbreakable.

B. I will. Softened corners are part of the visible shape you prefer, separate from the exact length we still need to confirm.

C. The almond outline narrows toward a rounded tip. In this particular sample, that outline is shown at a visibly longer length.

D. Certainly. We are comparing the silhouettes and lengths first. The technical method and the appropriate service still need their own discussion.

Answers and explanations, page 144

A Read the situation

LESSON 03 / EXPLAINING COLOR, COVERAGE, AND FINISH

Separate color, coverage, and finish while leaving an unspecified product system open for consultation.

> **Sheer pink, without the shine**
>
> Client Dana asks technician Noor for matte pink but points to a sheer glossy swatch. Dana explains that the desired result has low shine while the natural nail line remains visible. The selected swatch illustrates the preferred pink color and transparency, but not the preferred finish. The booking does not specify conventional lacquer or gel polish. Noor records the appearance as sheer pink with a low-shine finish, leaving product selection and suitability open rather than assuming the swatch chooses the whole service.

People: Dana, Client; Noor, Nail technician.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which appearance does Dana want?

A. Sheer pink with low shine
B. Opaque pink with high gloss
C. Clear colorless polish with glitter
D. Every feature of the glossy swatch

2. What should remain visible?

A. Only a solid opaque coating
B. A confirmed product label
C. An extension form
D. The natural nail line

3. Which product category is booked?

A. Gel polish is confirmed
B. Lacquer is confirmed
C. Both are automatically selected
D. Neither lacquer nor gel polish is specified

Answers and explanations, page 114

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

swatch
Sample showing a color or finish for comparison.
compare the swatch

hue
Basic color family, such as pink or red.
describe the hue

coverage
Degree to which the applied color conceals what is beneath it.
clarify the coverage

semi-sheer
Partially translucent, between very sheer and fully opaque.
compare semi-sheer coverage

translucency
Degree to which light and underlying detail show through.
describe translucency

finish
Surface appearance, including the level of shine.
clarify the finish

shade
Particular variation of a color.
choose a pink shade

undertone
Subtle underlying color character.
compare undertones

sheer
Translucent enough for some underlying nail detail to remain visible.
request sheer coverage

opaque
Concealing the underlying nail rather than allowing it to show through.
distinguish opaque coverage

nail line
Visible boundary toward the nail's free edge, used here as an appearance reference.
retain a visible nail line

matte
Low-shine or non-glossy surface appearance.
request a matte finish

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

swatch SWATCH

compare the swatch

Keep the meaning precise: Sample showing a color or finish for comparison.

sheer SHEER

request sheer coverage

Keep the meaning precise: Translucent enough for some underlying nail detail to remain visible.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

glossy
Shiny surface appearance.
identify the glossy swatch

satin
Soft-sheen appearance between matte and high gloss in a given range.
compare a satin finish

sheen
Degree of reflected shine.
describe the sheen

shimmer
Fine reflective sparkle within a color effect.
identify shimmer

glitter
Visible reflective particles used for a decorative effect.
distinguish glitter from gloss

metallic
Appearance resembling reflective metal.
describe a metallic effect

pearlescent
Soft luminous effect resembling the sheen of a pearl.
compare a pearlescent effect

top coat
Finishing coating whose properties depend on the product system.
discuss the top coat

color coat
Layer providing the selected color effect.
identify the color coat

product system
Compatible set of products and procedures for a service.
confirm the product system

appearance specification
Separate agreed details of color, coverage, and finish.
record the appearance specification

curing lamp
Light source specified for curing a compatible gel system; not selected by wattage alone.
verify the curing lamp

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

matte MATTE

request a matte finish

Keep the meaning precise: Low-shine or non-glossy surface appearance.

glitter GLITTER

distinguish glitter from gloss

Keep the meaning precise: Visible reflective particles used for a decorative effect.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Separate the choices

Let us check color, coverage, and finish one at a time.

Confirm the color

Pink is the color you prefer.

Ask about visibility

Do you want the natural nail line to remain visible?

Explain sheer

Sheer coverage allows some nail detail to show through.

Explain opaque

Opaque coverage conceals the underlying nail.

Explain matte

Matte describes a low-shine finish.

Describe the swatch

This swatch is sheer and glossy.

Identify the mismatch

You like its pink color and coverage, but not its shine.

Confirm the combined request

You want sheer pink with a low-shine finish.

Avoid a false conflict

Sheer and matte describe different features, so they are not opposites.

Clarify the booking

The booking does not specify lacquer or gel polish.

Keep product choice open

We still need to discuss the product system.

Avoid copying everything

Selecting this swatch does not select every feature it shows.

Ask for a read-back

Is visible nail line and low shine the right summary?

Avoid an application promise

We have not confirmed the product or method yet.

Close the appearance discussion

The appearance is clear; product selection remains open.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Explain sheer
Useful wording: Sheer coverage allows some nail detail to show through.

Purpose: Explain opaque
Useful wording: Opaque coverage conceals the underlying nail.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which statement explains the client's request?

A. Pink automatically means gel polish.

B. Sheer concerns visibility through the color; matte concerns shine.

C. Sheer always means glossy.

D. Matte always means opaque.

2. Which swatch feature is not wanted?

A. Its sheer coverage

B. Its visible underlying detail

C. Its glossy finish

D. Its pink color

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Subtle underlying color character. Which term fits?

A. sheen

B. undertone

C. color coat

D. translucency

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Sheer pink, without the shine". Dana: "Oh, I thought sheer meant shiny. The sheer samples I looked at all seemed glossy." Noor: [missing response] Dana: "Then this pink is right, and the transparency is right. It's the shiny surface I'd like changed." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I'll record matte as the finish preference. That keeps the low-shine request separate from the color.

B. That's sheer coverage. It describes the see-through quality, not the shine on top.

C. Let's check coverage first. Do you want the natural nail line to show through the pink?

D. Those samples combine two features. Their finish is glossy, but their coverage is sheer.

Answers and explanations, page 114

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Matte and sheer answer different questions. Matte concerns shine; sheer concerns how much underlying nail remains visible. The client can request both. The glossy swatch illustrates the preferred color and coverage, not the agreed final shine.

E Conversation

Sheer pink, without the shine

Sheer pink, without the shine

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

coverage / nail line / sample mismatch / matte / sheer / appearance specification / product system / Opaque / product category / finish

01 **Dana:** I want matte pink, like this sample. I like seeing a little of the nail through it, but I don't want it so shiny.

02 **Noor:** Let's check [1] _____ first. Do you want the natural nail line to show through the pink?

03 **Dana:** Yes. I want some color, just not a solid block that hides the nail underneath.

04 **Noor:** That's [2] _____ coverage. It describes the see-through quality, not the shine on top.

05 **Dana:** Oh, I thought sheer meant shiny. The sheer samples I looked at all seemed glossy.

06 **Noor:** Those samples combine two features. Their [3] _____ is glossy, but their coverage is sheer.

07 **Dana:** Then this pink is right, and the transparency is right. It's the shiny surface I'd like changed.

08 **Noor:** I'll record [4] _____ as the finish preference. That keeps the low-shine request separate from the color.

09 **Dana:** What would opaque look like? Is that another word for dark pink, or does it mean something else?

10 **Noor:** [5] _____ means you wouldn't see the underlying nail through the color. Pale colors can be opaque too.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Sheer pink, without the shine

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Dana:** Then I don't mean opaque. Please keep the nail line visible even though I don't want a glossy finish.

12 **Noor:** Yes. The [6] _____ stays in the appearance description. Low shine doesn't mean it has to be hidden.

13 **Dana:** Have I already booked gel polish? I don't remember choosing between that and ordinary polish on the form.

14 **Noor:** No [7] _____ is listed. We should discuss lacquer and gel polish separately from this swatch.

15 **Dana:** Could you explain the difference before I choose? I don't want to agree just because I pointed to this one.

16 **Noor:** Of course. We'll discuss the [8] _____ and the service involved. The sample has only helped clarify the look.

17 **Dana:** So my request is pink, slightly see-through, and not shiny. Is that the right way to put it?

18 **Noor:** Yes. That's a clear [9] _____: sheer pink with low shine.

19 **Dana:** Great. Keep those three points together, please. I'd be disappointed if matte turned into a completely solid pink.

20 **Noor:** I'll note the [10] _____ too: you like this swatch's color and transparency, but not its glossy surface.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. coverage / **2.** sheer / **3.** finish / **4.** matte / **5.** Opaque / **6.** nail line / **7.** product category / **8.** product system / **9.** appearance specification / **10.** sample mismatch

Why these answers fit, page 115

F Check accuracy and scope

Sheer pink, without the shine

Return to the case

Client Dana asks technician Noor for matte pink but points to a sheer glossy swatch. Dana explains that the desired result has low shine while the natural nail line remains visible. The selected swatch illustrates the preferred pink color and transparency, but not the preferred finish. The booking does not specify conventional lacquer or gel polish. Noor records the appearance as sheer pink with a low-shine finish, leaving product selection and suitability open rather than assuming the swatch chooses the whole service.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which record is accurate?

A. Colorless glitter, lacquer confirmed.
B. Every swatch feature accepted without discussion.
C. Sheer pink, low shine, product category not yet specified.
D. Glossy opaque pink, gel polish confirmed.

2. Which question best checks coverage?

A. Do you want the nail line to show through?
B. Would you like a shinier surface?
C. Do you prefer warm pink or cool pink?
D. Would you like a fine shimmer in the color?

Answers and explanations, page 116

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles and read the opaque explanation; preserve the distinction between pale color and see-through coverage.

Separate the details kindly

A client is not being inconsistent when one sample illustrates only part of a request. Ask which features they like and translate the answer into separate appearance choices. Avoid overwhelming the client with product names before the desired color, coverage, and finish are clear.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Decode another color request

A client wants opaque blue with a glossy finish. They do not want the nail line visible. The booking leaves lacquer versus gel polish unspecified.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

unspecified / glossy / blue / opaque

01 **Technician:** The requested color is [1] _____.

02 **Client:** I want [2] _____ coverage.

03 **Technician:** The requested finish is [3] _____.

04 **Reception:** The product category remains [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. blue / **2.** opaque / **3.** glossy / **4.** unspecified

Why these answers fit, page 117

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Sheer pink, without the shine". Dana: "Have I already booked gel polish? I don't remember choosing between that and ordinary polish on the form." Noor: [missing response] Dana: "Could you explain the difference before I choose? I don't want to agree just because I pointed to this one." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Opaque means you wouldn't see the underlying nail through the color. Pale colors can be opaque too.

B. No product category is listed. We should discuss lacquer and gel polish separately from this swatch.

C. I'll record matte as the finish preference. That keeps the low-shine request separate from the color.

D. Let's check coverage first. Do you want the natural nail line to show through the pink?

Answers and explanations, page 118

A Read the situation

LESSON 04 / AGREEING ON NAIL ART AND A COMPLETE QUOTE

Calculate a per-nail addition, offer complete priced alternatives, and confirm quantity and placement before starting.

Two accent nails within forty dollars

Client Ben wants simple line art on four nails but has a total limit of $40. Technician Rosa explains this fictional menu: the base service is $30, simple line art is $5 per nail, and no other charges apply in the exercise. Four decorated nails would cost $50. Two decorated nails would cost $40, or the base service alone would cost $30. Ben chooses two decorated nails, one ring fingernail on each hand. Rosa confirms that two means the total across both hands, not two on each hand.

People: Ben, Client; Rosa, Nail technician.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What would four decorated nails cost in total?

A. $35
B. $50
C. $40
D. $20

2. Which option meets the $40 limit with art?

A. Two decorated nails plus the base service
B. Four decorated nails plus the base service
C. Two decorated nails on each hand
D. The art charge alone without the base

3. Which placement is selected?

A. One ring fingernail on each hand
B. Two nails on each hand
C. Four nails on the left hand
D. All ten nails

Answers and explanations, page 119

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

nail art
Decorative design added to the nail appearance.
specify the nail art

accent nail
Nail given a distinct decorative treatment from the others.
select an accent nail

plain color
Color without the additional decorative design.
choose plain color

orientation
Direction in which a design faces.
clarify the orientation

stripe
Long narrow decorative line or band.
describe a stripe

negative space
Deliberately uncovered area within a design.
identify negative space

line art
Design formed primarily with lines.
quote simple line art

decorated nail
Nail included in the agreed art quantity.
count decorated nails

placement
Specific nail or area where the design appears.
confirm design placement

motif
Repeated or distinct decorative element.
choose a motif

dot detail
Decorative element made of small dots.
clarify the dot detail

French tip
Design emphasizing a contrasting appearance at the nail tip.
discuss a French-tip design

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

nail art NAIL ART

specify the nail art

Keep the meaning precise: Decorative design added to the nail appearance.

placement PLACEMENT

confirm design placement

Keep the meaning precise: Specific nail or area where the design appears.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

ombre
Gradual visual transition between colors or tones.
describe an ombre effect

base price
Cost of the underlying service before art additions.
state the base price

complete quote
Total price for the specifically described option.
give a complete quote

smile line
Curved boundary between a contrasting French tip and the rest of the nail design.
describe a crisp smile line

each hand
Separately referring to the left and right hands.
confirm one on each hand

design approval
Agreement to the specified design and placement.
obtain design approval

per-nail charge
Price applying to each decorated nail individually.
explain the per-nail charge

art subtotal
Total charge for the decorative additions alone.
calculate the art subtotal

budget limit
Maximum total the client agrees to spend.
respect the budget limit

ring fingernail
Nail on the finger between the middle and little fingers.
identify the ring fingernail

both hands
Referring to the two hands together.
total across both hands

additional charge
Amount added beyond the base service.
state the additional charge

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

French tip FRENCH TIP

discuss a French-tip design

Keep the meaning precise: Design emphasizing a contrasting appearance at the nail tip.

complete quote COMPLETE QUOTE

give a complete quote

Keep the meaning precise: Total price for the specifically described option.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Ask about the limit
Is $40 your total budget, including the base service?

State the base price
The base service is $30.

Explain the unit charge
Simple line art is $5 per decorated nail.

Calculate the first option
Four decorated nails add $20, making $50 total.

Offer the smaller option
Two decorated nails add $10, making $40 total.

Preserve the plain option
The base service alone is $30.

Keep totals complete
These totals include the base service and the stated art quantity.

Ask for a choice
Would you prefer two decorated nails or the base service alone?

Confirm the reduction
You are choosing two instead of the original four.

Clarify both hands
Do you mean two in total across both hands?

Check placement
Which two nails would you like decorated?

Name the fingers
One ring fingernail on each hand gives two in total.

Avoid silent additions
We will confirm any additional art before changing the price.

Read back the design
Simple line art on the two ring fingernails.

Read back the total
The agreed total is $40.

Confirm before starting
Let us settle quantity, placement, and price before beginning.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Calculate the first option
Useful wording: Four decorated nails add $20, making $50 total.

Purpose: Offer the smaller option
Useful wording: Two decorated nails add $10, making $40 total.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which quote is complete?

A. Two decorated nails at $10 plus the $30 base: $40 total.
B. Two nails cost $10, with the base omitted.
C. Four nails cost $40 including the base.
D. Two nails on each hand cost $40 total.

2. What does one ring fingernail on each hand mean?

A. Every fingernail on both hands
B. Two decorated nails in total
C. Four decorated nails in total
D. One decorated nail in total

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Nail included in the agreed art quantity. Which term fits?

A. stripe
B. each hand
C. base price
D. decorated nail

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two accent nails within forty dollars". Ben: "That is more than I can spend today. Is there a smaller version that stays within forty without changing the base service?" Rosa: [missing response] Ben: "And if I decide not to have any art at all, would the base service still be available at thirty?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The per-nail charge makes four decorated nails twenty dollars extra. Added to the thirty-dollar base service, that gives a total of fifty dollars.

B. Two decorated nails would have an art subtotal of ten dollars. With the base service, the complete total would be forty dollars.

C. Two altogether, across both hands. Two on each hand would be four nails and would return the total to fifty dollars.

D. That gives one accent nail on each hand. I will specify the two ring fingernails so the placement is not left to an assumption.

Answers and explanations, page 119

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Four decorated nails cost $20 in art charges, making $50 with the base service. Two decorated nails cost $10 in art charges, making $40 total. Two on each hand would be four in total and exceed the stated budget.

E Conversation

Two accent nails within forty dollars

Two accent nails within forty dollars

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

base price / placement / accent nail / art subtotal / design approval / both hands / per-nail charge / budget limit / quantity reduction / complete quote

01 **Ben:** I would like the simple line design on four nails, but I need to keep the whole appointment at forty dollars. Does that work?

02 **Rosa:** Let me give you the [1] _____ before we choose. The base service is thirty dollars, and simple line art is five dollars for each decorated nail.

03 **Ben:** I had thought five dollars meant the whole design, not five for every nail. What would the four-nail version come to?

04 **Rosa:** The [2] _____ makes four decorated nails twenty dollars extra. Added to the thirty-dollar base service, that gives a total of fifty dollars.

05 **Ben:** That is more than I can spend today. Is there a smaller version that stays within forty without changing the base service?

06 **Rosa:** Two decorated nails would have an [3] _____ of ten dollars. With the base service, the complete total would be forty dollars.

07 **Ben:** And if I decide not to have any art at all, would the base service still be available at thirty?

08 **Rosa:** Yes. The [4] _____ is thirty dollars without the art. Your two choices within the limit are the base alone or the base with two decorated nails.

09 **Ben:** Let's do two with the line design, then. I can manage forty, but not fifty today.

10 **Rosa:** I will confirm that [5] _____ with you: two decorated nails instead of four, for forty dollars in total.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Two accent nails within forty dollars

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Ben:** When you say two, is that two on each hand or two altogether? I want to make sure I am counting the same way.

12 **Rosa:** Two altogether, across [6] _____. Two on each hand would be four nails and would return the total to fifty dollars.

13 **Ben:** Then one on each hand sounds right. I would like the ring fingernails decorated, with the other nails left without that line design.

14 **Rosa:** That gives one [7] _____ on each hand. I will specify the two ring fingernails so the placement is not left to an assumption.

15 **Ben:** Yes, these two. Please leave the others plain; I like the design better on the ring fingers.

16 **Rosa:** The [8] _____ is now clear: the ring fingernail on your left hand and the ring fingernail on your right.

17 **Ben:** Good. And forty is still the complete total, not forty plus another amount for selecting those fingers?

18 **Rosa:** Correct. Your [9] _____ is met by this option. There are no other charges in this comparison, and the two-nail art total remains ten dollars.

19 **Ben:** That's agreed: both ring fingernails, forty dollars altogether. No extra art today.

20 **Rosa:** I have your [10] _____ for that exact option. We will confirm any later change before altering the quantity, placement, or price, rather than adding something without asking.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. complete quote / **2.** per-nail charge / **3.** art subtotal / **4.** base price / **5.** quantity reduction / **6.** both hands / **7.** accent nail / **8.** placement / **9.** budget limit / **10.** design approval

Why these answers fit, page 120

F Check accuracy and scope

Two accent nails within forty dollars

Return to the case

Client Ben wants simple line art on four nails but has a total limit of $40. Technician Rosa explains this fictional menu: the base service is $30, simple line art is $5 per nail, and no other charges apply in the exercise. Four decorated nails would cost $50. Two decorated nails would cost $40, or the base service alone would cost $30. Ben chooses two decorated nails, one ring fingernail on each hand. Rosa confirms that two means the total across both hands, not two on each hand.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which response wrongly assumes agreement?

A. The base service alone is $30.

B. Which two nails would you like decorated?

C. I reduced your four-nail design without asking so the bill fits.

D. Two decorated nails would total $40.

2. Which change would exceed the accepted quantity?

A. Leaving the other nails without this art

B. Decorating two nails on each hand

C. Decorating one ring fingernail per hand

D. Keeping the art subtotal at $10

Answers and explanations, page 122

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles for the placement exchange. Say one on each hand and two altogether distinctly.

Make the quantity visible in the price

Per-nail charges can be misunderstood as per-hand or whole-set prices. State the quantity, the additional amount, and the complete total together. Offering a smaller design within a budget is helpful only if the client explicitly chooses the change.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Recalculate another art quote

A base service costs $35. Art costs $4 per nail, with no other charges. The client has a $43 limit and chooses one decorated nail on each hand.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

forty-three / eight / limit / two

01 **Technician:** The selected quantity is [1] _____ nails.

02 **Client:** The art subtotal is [2] _____ dollars.

03 **Technician:** The complete total is [3] _____ dollars.

04 **Client:** That total meets my budget [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. two / **2.** eight / **3.** forty-three / **4.** limit

Why these answers fit, page 122

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two accent nails within forty dollars". Ben: "Then one on each hand sounds right. I would like the ring fingernails decorated, with the other nails left without that line design." Rosa: [missing response] Ben: "Yes, these two. Please leave the others plain; I like the design better on the ring fingers." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That gives one accent nail on each hand. I will specify the two ring fingernails so the placement is not left to an assumption.

B. Two decorated nails would have an art subtotal of ten dollars. With the base service, the complete total would be forty dollars.

C. Correct. Your budget limit is met by this option. There are no other charges in this comparison, and the two-nail art total remains ten dollars.

D. The per-nail charge makes four decorated nails twenty dollars extra. Added to the thirty-dollar base service, that gives a total of fifty dollars.

Answers and explanations, page 123

Review 2 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Explaining color, coverage, and finish" and "Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Basic color family, such as pink or red. Which term fits?

A. hue
B. top coat
C. opaque
D. satin

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Repeated or distinct decorative element. Which term fits?

A. motif
B. nail art
C. ombre
D. smile line

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A shape that fits the working day". Amara: "The shorter one seems less likely to get in my way. Does that mean it will definitely be comfortable when I type?" Kai: [missing response] Amara: "Does squoval mean it won't break? A friend told me it was the strongest shape." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. The suitability assessment and remaining details still matter. We have a clear direction: short length for keyboard work, with the squoval appearance preferred.
B. I cannot give a comfort guarantee from a sample. Your work needs help guide the consultation, but they do not prove how a particular result will feel on your actual nails.
C. Yes, we still need an agreed length reference for your actual nails. The word short is useful, but it should not be the only detail in the final agreement.
D. The practical requirement is a short result, then. We can compare the shape you like without assuming you want the full length of this display sample.

Review 2 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two accent nails within forty dollars". Ben: "Good. And forty is still the complete total, not forty plus another amount for selecting those fingers?" Rosa: [missing response] Ben: "That's agreed: both ring fingernails, forty dollars altogether. No extra art today." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. Your budget limit is met by this option. There are no other charges in this comparison, and the two-nail art total remains ten dollars.

B. That gives one accent nail on each hand. I will specify the two ring fingernails so the placement is not left to an assumption.

C. The per-nail charge makes four decorated nails twenty dollars extra. Added to the thirty-dollar base service, that gives a total of fifty dollars.

D. Let me give you the complete quote before we choose. The base service is thirty dollars, and simple line art is five dollars for each decorated nail.

Answers and explanations, page 146

A Read the situation

LESSON 05 / RESPONDING TO DISCOMFORT AND UNCERTAIN NAIL CONCERNS

Pause a cosmetic request, preserve the client report, and distinguish healthcare referral from salon service approval.

> **Do not cover an unexplained concern**
>
> Before any service starts, client Elena reports unexplained tenderness beside one nail. Elena wants technician Dev to cover the area with product for an event. Dev pauses that request and recommends assessment by an appropriate healthcare professional without naming a condition or suggesting treatment. Elena agrees to seek appropriate advice. The salon must separately assess whether a cosmetic service is suitable. No product has been applied, no cause is established, and the healthcare referral does not guarantee that the salon will approve the requested service.

People: Elena, Client; Dev, Nail technician.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What does Elena report?

A. A reaction after today's product application
B. A completed cosmetic repair
C. Unexplained tenderness beside one nail
D. A confirmed medical diagnosis

2. What happens to the covering request?

A. Product is applied immediately
B. It is approved after a guess
C. It becomes a treatment prescription
D. It is paused

3. What does referral establish?

A. A confirmed cause
B. Permission to conceal the area
C. A route to appropriate health assessment, not service approval
D. A guarantee of a manicure

Answers and explanations, page 124

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

tenderness
Reported soreness or sensitivity, particularly with touch or pressure.

report tenderness

adjacent skin
Skin beside the nail or another specified area.

describe adjacent skin

swelling
Enlargement or puffiness, if actually observed or reported.

describe reported swelling

allergic reaction
Health response requiring appropriate assessment, not a salon guess.

refer a suspected allergic reaction

unexplained concern
Concern whose cause has not been established.

acknowledge an unexplained concern

affected area
Specific location involved in the reported concern.

identify the affected area

nail fold
Skin bordering the nail plate.

identify the nail-fold area

redness
Visible red appearance, if actually observed or reported.

record reported redness

irritation
Uncomfortable response that should not be assigned a cause without assessment.

report possible irritation

sensitivity
Reported heightened response to touch or a substance.

clarify reported sensitivity

symptom description
Client's words about what they experience.

preserve the symptom description

onset
Time when the reported concern began.

clarify reported onset

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

tenderness TENDERNESS

report tenderness

Keep the meaning precise: Reported soreness or sensitivity, particularly with touch or pressure.

irritation IRRITATION

report possible irritation

Keep the meaning precise: Uncomfortable response that should not be assigned a cause without assessment.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

pre-existing concern

Concern present before the proposed service begins.

record a pre-existing concern

covering product

Product proposed to conceal an area or change its appearance.

decline to apply a covering product

healthcare professional

Appropriately qualified person who assesses health concerns.

refer to a healthcare professional

diagnosis

Identification of a health condition through appropriate clinical assessment.

avoid giving a diagnosis

cosmetic suitability

Whether the proposed cosmetic service is appropriate after assessment.

assess cosmetic suitability

event deadline

Client's preferred timing because of an upcoming event.

acknowledge the event deadline

cosmetic request

Request to alter appearance, distinct from healthcare treatment.

pause the cosmetic request

service pause

Temporary stop pending the appropriate next steps.

maintain the service pause

referral

Direction to an appropriate professional or service for further assessment.

explain the referral

treatment advice

Recommendation intended to address a health condition.

avoid unsupported treatment advice

service approval

Salon decision authorizing a specific service under its process.

distinguish service approval

factual note

Record limited to the reported or observed facts and agreed actions.

make a factual note

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

onset ONSET

clarify reported onset

Keep the meaning precise: Time when the reported concern began.

healthcare professional HEALTHCARE PROFESSIONAL

refer to a healthcare professional

Keep the meaning precise: Appropriately qualified person who assesses health concerns.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the concern
Thank you for telling me about the tenderness.

State the timing
This was reported before any service began.

Avoid a diagnosis
I cannot determine what is causing the tenderness.

Avoid treatment advice
I cannot recommend a treatment for an unexplained health concern.

Keep the boundary
The event does not establish that applying product is suitable.

Separate the decisions
The salon must assess cosmetic suitability separately.

Preserve the client's words
I will record tenderness beside one nail, without adding a condition name.

Keep the request pending
The cosmetic request remains paused.

Clarify the location
You are describing the area beside this nail.

Pause the request
I will pause the request to cover that area with product.

Refer appropriately
Please have the concern assessed by an appropriate healthcare professional.

Acknowledge the event
I understand why you wanted a cosmetic result for the event.

State what has not happened
No product has been applied.

Avoid a future guarantee
The referral does not guarantee service approval afterward.

Confirm the next step
You will seek appropriate healthcare advice about the concern.

Close factually
No cause is established and no covering service is approved.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Pause the request
Useful wording: I will pause the request to cover that area with product.

Purpose: Avoid a diagnosis
Useful wording: I cannot determine what is causing the tenderness.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which note stays factual?

A. Today's product caused the condition.

B. Product applied to solve the concern.

C. Tenderness beside one nail reported before service; covering request paused.

D. Infection confirmed by the technician.

2. Which response overpromises?

A. The cause has not been established.

B. After the referral, we will definitely perform the requested service.

C. The cosmetic request remains paused.

D. No product has been applied.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Visible red appearance, if actually observed or reported. Which term fits?

A. cosmetic suitability

B. covering product

C. redness

D. unexplained concern

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Do not cover an unexplained concern". Elena: "It's beside this nail, not all over my hand. Can you see where I'm pointing?" Dev: [missing response] Elena: "Yes. It was there before I arrived, and nothing from today's appointment has been put on it." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Cosmetic suitability is not established simply by making a referral. We should not promise approval before the relevant decisions have been made.

B. Please have the concern assessed by an appropriate healthcare professional. I cannot determine the cause or recommend treatment from this salon conversation.

C. You are reporting tenderness beside this nail. I will keep that description rather than add a condition name or assume a cause.

D. No. The referral does not guarantee that. The salon must separately decide whether the proposed cosmetic service is suitable through its normal process.

Answers and explanations, page 124

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Tenderness is the reported concern, not a diagnosis. It was present before any service began. The request to cover it is paused, with no product applied. Refer the health question without naming a cause or recommending treatment.

E Conversation

Do not cover an unexplained concern

Do not cover an unexplained concern

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

pause / healthcare professional / diagnosis / tenderness / pre-existing concern / event deadline / referral / Cosmetic suitability / service approval / factual note

01 **Elena:** Before we start, I should mention that the area beside this nail is tender. Could you cover it with product so it looks better for my event?

02 **Dev:** Thank you for telling me. I will [1] _____ that request for now. The tenderness needs appropriate attention before we make assumptions about a cosmetic service.

03 **Elena:** I do not know what caused it. I was hoping the appointment could still go ahead because the event is important to me.

04 **Dev:** I understand the [2] _____. It matters to your plans, but it does not tell us whether applying product to the area is suitable.

05 **Elena:** It's beside this nail, not all over my hand. Can you see where I'm pointing?

06 **Dev:** You are reporting [3] _____ beside this nail. I will keep that description rather than add a condition name or assume a cause.

07 **Elena:** Yes. It was there before I arrived, and nothing from today's appointment has been put on it.

08 **Dev:** I will record it as a [4] _____. No product has been applied today, and no service has started.

09 **Elena:** Who should I ask about it? I haven't had it checked, and I don't know what's causing it.

10 **Dev:** Please have the concern assessed by an appropriate [5] _____. I cannot determine the cause or recommend treatment from this salon conversation.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Do not cover an unexplained concern

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Elena:** If I get advice, can I come back for the service afterwards?

12 **Dev:** No. The [6] _____ does not guarantee that. The salon must separately decide whether the proposed cosmetic service is suitable through its normal process.

13 **Elena:** So I need advice about the soreness first, and then we'd discuss whether the nail service can go ahead.

14 **Dev:** Exactly. [7] _____ is not established simply by making a referral. We should not promise approval before the relevant decisions have been made.

15 **Elena:** Please just note what I told you. Nobody has diagnosed it yet.

16 **Dev:** I will make a [8] _____ with your description, the fact that it was reported before service, and the request to cover it being paused.

17 **Elena:** That is accurate. I will seek appropriate healthcare advice, and I understand that you are not suggesting a treatment here.

18 **Dev:** Correct. I am not giving a [9] _____ or treatment advice. The immediate salon decision is not to apply a covering product to this unexplained concern.

19 **Elena:** Okay, I won't ask you to cover it. I'll get advice about the tenderness first.

20 **Dev:** The [10] _____ remains unresolved. No cause is established, no product has been applied, and the cosmetic request stays paused while you seek the appropriate advice.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. pause / **2.** event deadline / **3.** tenderness / **4.** pre-existing concern / **5.** healthcare professional / **6.** referral / **7.** Cosmetic suitability / **8.** factual note / **9.** diagnosis / **10.** service approval

Why these answers fit, page 125

F Check accuracy and scope

Do not cover an unexplained concern

Return to the case

Before any service starts, client Elena reports unexplained tenderness beside one nail. Elena wants technician Dev to cover the area with product for an event. Dev pauses that request and recommends assessment by an appropriate healthcare professional without naming a condition or suggesting treatment. Elena agrees to seek appropriate advice. The salon must separately assess whether a cosmetic service is suitable. No product has been applied, no cause is established, and the healthcare referral does not guarantee that the salon will approve the requested service.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which next step addresses the health question?

A. Guessing from an unrelated photograph
B. Assessment by an appropriate healthcare professional
C. Covering the area for the event
D. Selecting a color to conceal it

2. Which distinction matters?

A. A referral is a treatment prescription.
B. Healthcare assessment and cosmetic-service suitability are separate decisions.
C. A client deadline equals service approval.
D. Tenderness always identifies one condition.

Answers and explanations, page 126

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles and read the referral exchange. Do not substitute an invented diagnosis for tenderness.

A clear boundary can still be kind

Acknowledge why the event matters without making appearance more important than an unexplained concern. Use the client's own description, state what you cannot establish, and explain the next step calmly. A referral should not sound like either a diagnosis or a promise of later approval.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Separate referral from service approval

Before service, a client reports unexplained soreness beside one nail. No product is applied. The covering request is paused, and the client is directed to an appropriate healthcare professional. Salon suitability remains unassessed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

soreness / paused / applied / unassessed

01 **Technician:** The reported concern is [1] _____ beside one nail.

02 **Client:** No product has been [2] _____.

03 **Technician:** The covering request remains [3] _____.

04 **Reception:** Cosmetic suitability is still [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. soreness / **2.** applied / **3.** paused / **4.** unassessed

Why these answers fit, page 127

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Do not cover an unexplained concern". Elena: "So I need advice about the soreness first, and then we'd discuss whether the nail service can go ahead." Dev: [missing response] Elena: "Please just note what I told you. Nobody has diagnosed it yet." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Cosmetic suitability is not established simply by making a referral. We should not promise approval before the relevant decisions have been made.

B. I understand the event deadline. It matters to your plans, but it does not tell us whether applying product to the area is suitable.

C. No. The referral does not guarantee that. The salon must separately decide whether the proposed cosmetic service is suitable through its normal process.

D. You are reporting tenderness beside this nail. I will keep that description rather than add a condition name or assume a cause.

Answers and explanations, page 128

A Read the situation

LESSON 06 / GIVING A CLEAR STATION-READINESS UPDATE

Distinguish visible tidiness from completed readiness checks and offer a verified alternative without inventing a release time.

Tidy is not confirmed ready

Receptionist Maya needs a station for a waiting client. Technician Owen reports that station three looks tidy but its required readiness checks are incomplete. Responsible technician Rosa has confirmed station two ready. Owen offers station two and keeps station three marked pending until its actual checks are completed and readiness is confirmed through the salon process. No completion time for station three is known. This is a communication task, not a set of cleaning, disinfection, equipment, or chemical-use instructions.

People: Maya, Receptionist; Owen, Nail technician.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. Which station is confirmed ready?

A. Both stations
B. Neither station
C. Station two
D. Station three

2. What is station three's status?

A. Already in use with approval
B. Tidy, with required checks incomplete
C. Confirmed ready because it looks tidy
D. Permanently closed

3. What time will station three be ready?

A. Before the client sits down
B. It was ready earlier
C. No completion time is known
D. Exactly five minutes from now

Answers and explanations, page 129

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

station
Designated work area for a client service.

identify the station

readiness check
Required review before a station is confirmed available for use.

complete a readiness check

confirmed ready
Status supported by the responsible person's completed process.

report confirmed-ready status

pending status
State of waiting for an unfinished check or decision.

keep the pending status

tidiness
Visible orderliness, not proof of completed hygiene or readiness checks.

distinguish tidiness from readiness

cleaning
Removal of dirt or material, distinct from every further required process.

distinguish cleaning from disinfection

disinfection
Process intended to control specified microorganisms under applicable instructions.

refer to disinfection requirements

single-use item
Item intended for one use under its instructions.

identify a single-use item

reusable implement
Tool intended for repeated use subject to the required processing.

identify a reusable implement

service tray
Surface or container holding items for a service.

identify the service tray

work surface
Surface used during the service.

check work-surface status

clean storage
Designated storage for appropriately prepared items.

identify clean storage

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

station STATION

identify the station

Keep the meaning precise: Designated work area for a client service.

cleaning CLEANING

distinguish cleaning from disinfection

Keep the meaning precise: Removal of dirt or material, distinct from every further required process.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

used-item area

Designated place for items awaiting the required handling.

identify the used-item area

product label

Product information including identity, instructions, and warnings.

consult the product label

ventilation

Movement or exchange of air through the relevant workplace system.

report a ventilation concern

personal protective equipment

Equipment used to reduce exposure to workplace hazards.

confirm required personal protective equipment

responsible technician

Person accountable for the relevant station confirmation.

name the responsible technician

waste container

Receptacle for waste under the applicable procedure.

check the waste container

safety data sheet

Document describing a product's hazards and relevant safety information.

locate the safety data sheet

local exhaust

System capturing airborne material near its source.

identify local exhaust

check record

Record showing what has been checked and its status.

update the check record

release confirmation

Statement that the station has met the required readiness process.

await release confirmation

B Precision and professional shorthand / continued

sterilization

Validated process eliminating viable microorganisms including bacterial spores; not a synonym for storage.

distinguish disinfection from sterilization

cross-contamination

Transfer of unwanted microorganisms or material between tools, surfaces, or people.

prevent cross-contamination

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

clean storage CLEAN STORAGE

identify clean storage

Keep the meaning precise: Designated storage for appropriately prepared items.

ventilation VENTILATION

report a ventilation concern

Keep the meaning precise: Movement or exchange of air through the relevant workplace system.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Identify the station

Station three is the one still awaiting checks.

Describe only what is known

It looks tidy, but its required checks are incomplete.

Avoid an appearance shortcut

Tidiness does not establish confirmed readiness.

State the verified alternative

Station two has been confirmed ready.

Name the confirmation source

Rosa is the responsible technician who confirmed it.

Offer a workable next step

We can offer the client station two.

Keep the pending status

Station three should remain marked pending.

Avoid a guessed time

I do not have a confirmed completion time for station three.

Acknowledge the wait

I know the client is waiting; we have a verified alternative.

Ask a precise question

Which station has completed the required readiness process?

Keep procedures separate

The checks must follow the actual salon process.

Prevent an inaccurate update

Please do not change three to ready because the surface looks clear.

Read back the numbers

Two is confirmed ready; three is pending.

Confirm the next update

We will update three after the required confirmation.

Give a client-facing message

A confirmed-ready station is available for you.

Close the handover

Use the verified status, not an estimate based on appearance.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: State the verified alternative
Useful wording: Station two has been confirmed ready.

Purpose: Name the confirmation source
Useful wording: Rosa is the responsible technician who confirmed it.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which handover is accurate?

A. Three ready and two awaiting review.

B. Three ready in five minutes without a source.

C. Two confirmed ready by Rosa; three tidy with checks incomplete.

D. Both ready because the room looks neat.

2. Which message should reception give the client?

A. Station three will definitely be ready immediately.

B. A confirmed-ready station is available at station two.

C. Station three is ready because its table is empty.

D. All checks are optional when someone is waiting.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: State of waiting for an unfinished check or decision. Which term fits?

A. pending status

B. responsible technician

C. reusable implement

D. product label

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Tidy is not confirmed ready". Maya: "The board says almost ready beside three. Should that say pending instead?" Owen: [missing response] Maya: "I'll change the label. Do you know how long the remaining checks will take?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. We still need the release confirmation after the checks. Their willingness doesn't complete our responsibilities.

B. That's an accurate read-back. It should prevent the ready label ending up beside the wrong station.

C. Not yet. It's tidy, but the readiness checks aren't complete. Station two is the one Rosa has confirmed ready.

D. Yes. Pending makes the status clearer. Almost ready could encourage someone else to seat a client there.

Answers and explanations, page 129

> **One useful distinction**
>
> Station three is tidy but not confirmed ready because required checks are incomplete. Station two is confirmed ready by Rosa. Offer the verified alternative without silently upgrading station three or inventing a completion time.

E Conversation

Tidy is not confirmed ready

Tidy is not confirmed ready

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

Pending / readiness handover / completion time / readiness check / read-back / release confirmation / confirmed ready / available alternative / responsible technician / tidy

01 **Maya:** Can I seat the waiting client at station three? The table looks clear from here.

02 **Owen:** Not yet. It's [1] _____, but the readiness checks aren't complete. Station two is the one Rosa has confirmed ready.

03 **Maya:** Two, not three. Thanks for catching that. I'll move the client to two rather than leave them standing at reception.

04 **Owen:** Yes, that's the [2] _____. Three needs to stay out of use until the remaining checks are finished and confirmed.

05 **Maya:** The board says almost ready beside three. Should that say pending instead?

06 **Owen:** Yes. [3] _____ makes the status clearer. Almost ready could encourage someone else to seat a client there.

07 **Maya:** I'll change the label. Do you know how long the remaining checks will take?

08 **Owen:** I don't have a confirmed [4] _____ yet. Please don't promise the next client five minutes on that basis.

09 **Maya:** All right. For the client who's here, I'll say we have another station available now.

10 **Owen:** That works. Station two is [5] _____; we don't need to give the client a detailed account of the unfinished checks elsewhere.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Tidy is not confirmed ready

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Maya:** Who confirmed two? I'd like to put the name in the note so the next receptionist can see it.

12 **Owen:** Rosa is the [6] _____. She's already given that confirmation, so you can name her.

13 **Maya:** Good. Does a cleared work surface at three tell us anything about the tools that will be used there?

14 **Owen:** Not by itself. The [7] _____ follows our actual process. An empty table doesn't establish that the tools or other requirements are ready.

15 **Maya:** Then I'll leave the station pending, even if the client says they're happy to sit there.

16 **Owen:** Correct. We still need the [8] _____ after the checks. Their willingness doesn't complete our responsibilities.

17 **Maya:** Let me repeat it: two ready, confirmed by Rosa; three pending, no confirmed time. Is that everything?

18 **Owen:** That's an accurate [9] _____. It should prevent the ready label ending up beside the wrong station.

19 **Maya:** I'll offer two now and wait for an actual update before changing three on the board.

20 **Owen:** Thanks. Keep that [10] _____ for the next receptionist too, so nobody has to guess from what the room looks like.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. tidy / **2.** available alternative / **3.** Pending / **4.** completion time / **5.** confirmed ready / **6.** responsible technician / **7.** readiness check / **8.** release confirmation / **9.** read-back / **10.** readiness handover

Why these answers fit, page 130

F Check accuracy and scope

Tidy is not confirmed ready

Return to the case

Receptionist Maya needs a station for a waiting client. Technician Owen reports that station three looks tidy but its required readiness checks are incomplete. Responsible technician Rosa has confirmed station two ready. Owen offers station two and keeps station three marked pending until its actual checks are completed and readiness is confirmed through the salon process. No completion time for station three is known. This is a communication task, not a set of cleaning, disinfection, equipment, or chemical-use instructions.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. What would justify updating station three's status?

A. Completion of its required checks and the actual readiness confirmation
B. A shorter queue
C. A tidy appearance alone
D. A client's willingness to sit there

2. Which question is most precise?

A. Is the tabletop at station three clear of used items?
B. Has the waiting client agreed to use station three?
C. Has station three received the required readiness confirmation?
D. Does everything seem fine?

Answers and explanations, page 131

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Read the no-confirmed-time response without adding a five-minute estimate.

Use status words colleagues can act on

Tidy, nearly done, and should be fine may sound reassuring while leaving an essential check unclear. Give the specific station, verified status, and available next step. A waiting client creates a scheduling need, not evidence that unfinished checks can be treated as complete.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Read back different station numbers

Station five is tidy but has incomplete required checks. Station one is confirmed ready by technician Jo. No completion time is known for five. A waiting client can be offered one.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

one / Jo / time / pending

01 **Reception:** The verified alternative is station [1] _____.

02 **Technician:** Station five remains [2] _____.

03 **Reception:** The confirming technician for one is [3] _____.

04 **Technician:** Five has no confirmed completion [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. one / **2.** pending / **3.** Jo / **4.** time

Why these answers fit, page 132

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Tidy is not confirmed ready". Maya: "Good. Does a cleared work surface at three tell us anything about the tools that will be used there?" Owen: [missing response] Maya: "Then I'll leave the station pending, even if the client says they're happy to sit there." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That works. Station two is confirmed ready; we don't need to give the client a detailed account of the unfinished checks elsewhere.

B. Thanks. Keep that readiness handover for the next receptionist too, so nobody has to guess from what the room looks like.

C. Not by itself. The readiness check follows our actual process. An empty table doesn't establish that the tools or other requirements are ready.

D. Yes, that's the available alternative. Three needs to stay out of use until the remaining checks are finished and confirmed.

Answers and explanations, page 133

Review 3 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns" and "Giving a clear station-readiness update". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Skin beside the nail or another specified area. Which term fits?

A. treatment advice

B. adjacent skin

C. cosmetic request

D. sensitivity

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Item intended for one use under its instructions. Which term fits?

A. personal protective equipment

B. used-item area

C. station

D. single-use item

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Two accent nails within forty dollars". Ben: "Let's do two with the line design, then. I can manage forty, but not fifty today." Rosa: [missing response] Ben: "When you say two, is that two on each hand or two altogether? I want to make sure I am counting the same way." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Two decorated nails would have an art subtotal of ten dollars. With the base service, the complete total would be forty dollars.

B. The placement is now clear: the ring fingernail on your left hand and the ring fingernail on your right.

C. Two altogether, across both hands. Two on each hand would be four nails and would return the total to fifty dollars.

D. I will confirm that quantity reduction with you: two decorated nails instead of four, for forty dollars in total.

Review 3 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Tidy is not confirmed ready". Maya: "Let me repeat it: two ready, confirmed by Rosa; three pending, no confirmed time. Is that everything?" Owen: [missing response] Maya: "I'll offer two now and wait for an actual update before changing three on the board." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. We still need the release confirmation after the checks. Their willingness doesn't complete our responsibilities.

B. Rosa is the responsible technician. She's already given that confirmation, so you can name her.

C. That's an accurate read-back. It should prevent the ready label ending up beside the wrong station.

D. Yes. Pending makes the status clearer. Almost ready could encourage someone else to seat a client there.

Answers and explanations, page 148

A Read the situation

LESSON 07 / HANDLING A CHIP OR DESIGN CONCERN

Acknowledge a documented design-direction mismatch and offer a review without promising an unassessed correction.

> **The lettering faces the wrong way**
>
> Client Imani contacts receptionist Alex because the line-art lettering on the finished nails faces away from the client. Imani requested lettering facing toward the client, and the service record confirms that original direction. A review with technician Rosa is available today at 4:00 with no review fee. Imani accepts that review. No correction method, correction price, refund, or completion time has been assessed or approved. Alex must recognize the documented mismatch without claiming that the no-fee review guarantees a free or immediate particular correction.

People: Imani, Client; Alex, Receptionist.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What direction was requested and recorded?

A. No direction was discussed
B. A direction chosen later by reception
C. Lettering facing toward the client
D. Lettering facing away from the client

2. What is available today?

A. A guaranteed full correction at 4:00
B. An approved refund at 4:00
C. A completed replacement design
D. A no-fee review at 4:00

3. What does no review fee mean?

A. Every possible correction is free
B. Every future service is free
C. A refund has already been paid
D. The review itself has no charge

Answers and explanations, page 134

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

design concern
Client's issue with an aspect of the finished decoration.

acknowledge a design concern

lettering
Letters used as part of the nail-art design.

check the lettering

facing toward
Oriented so the relevant front faces the named viewer.

confirm lettering facing toward the client

facing away
Oriented in the opposite direction from the named viewer.

report lettering facing away

orientation mismatch
Difference between the agreed and delivered direction.

acknowledge an orientation mismatch

viewing perspective
Position from which the design is meant to be read.

clarify the viewing perspective

legibility
Ease of reading the lettering.

discuss legibility

design brief
Agreed description of the requested decoration.

refer to the design brief

service record
Record of the original request and service details.

check the service record

documented request
Preference supported by the existing record.

acknowledge the documented request

finished result
Appearance after the service has been performed.

review the finished result

chip
Small area of product or coating that has broken away.

report a chip

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

design concern DESIGN CONCERN

acknowledge a design concern

Keep the meaning precise: Client's issue with an aspect of the finished decoration.

viewing perspective VIEWING PERSPECTIVE

clarify the viewing perspective

Keep the meaning precise: Position from which the design is meant to be read.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

lifting

Separation of enhancement material from the nail surface.

report lifting

wear concern

Report about how the result has changed during use.

record a wear concern

review appointment

Meeting to examine a concern before deciding a response.

confirm the review appointment

review fee

Charge for the assessment appointment itself.

clarify the review fee

correction method

Proposed way of addressing an assessed design issue.

assess the correction method

correction estimate

Provisional price or time for a proposed remedy.

provide a correction estimate

remedy decision

Decision about what response is appropriate.

separate the remedy decision

refund approval

Authorized decision to return money.

distinguish refund approval

completion promise

Commitment about when work will be finished.

avoid an unsupported completion promise

specific acknowledgment

Recognition of the exact issue rather than a generic apology.

give a specific acknowledgment

case note

Factual record of the concern and agreed next step.

update the case note

review confirmation

Agreement on the time and purpose of the review.

send the review confirmation

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

chip CHIP

report a chip

Keep the meaning precise: Small area of product or coating that has broken away.

correction method CORRECTION METHOD

assess the correction method

Keep the meaning precise: Proposed way of addressing an assessed design issue.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Acknowledge the detail
You requested the lettering facing toward you.

Describe the concern
You are reporting that the finished lettering faces away.

Offer the review
Rosa can review the concern today at 4:00.

Separate review from remedy
The correction needs assessment before we promise a method.

Keep refund status clear
No refund has been approved.

Ask for acceptance
Would you like the 4:00 review?

Preserve the orientation
I will record toward you as the original request.

Read back the arrangement
Today at 4:00 with Rosa, for a no-fee review.

Use the record
The service record confirms that direction.

Avoid an argument over preference
We do not need to treat the recorded direction as a new request.

State the limited fee fact
There is no fee for that review.

Avoid expanding the fee statement
No review fee does not establish the price of unassessed further work.

Avoid a finish-time promise
We have not established when any correction could be completed.

Confirm the purpose
The appointment is to examine the design-direction concern.

Keep the report precise
This concern is about direction, not a reported chip.

Close with the next step
We will discuss any proposed remedy after the review.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Avoid an argument over preference
Useful wording: We do not need to treat the recorded direction as a new request.

Purpose: Offer the review
Useful wording: Rosa can review the concern today at 4:00.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which acknowledgment matches the record?

A. You requested lettering facing toward you, and that direction is recorded.

B. You never specified a direction.

C. You requested lettering facing away.

D. You are changing the original design brief.

2. Which promise exceeds the supplied facts?

A. No refund has been approved.

B. Every correction will be free and completed during the review.

C. The review has no fee.

D. Rosa is available at 4:00.

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Oriented in the opposite direction from the named viewer. Which term fits?

A. service record

B. review appointment

C. facing away

D. completion promise

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "The lettering faces the wrong way". Imani: "Can Rosa look at it today? I can come back if there's an appointment." Alex: [missing response] Imani: "Would I have to pay just to come back and show her the problem?" Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I can't make a completion promise for a correction yet. Four is the review time, not a guaranteed finish time.

B. She needs to assess the correction method with you first. I don't want to promise a procedure we haven't discussed.

C. She has a review appointment at four. She can look at the lettering with you and discuss what happens next.

D. There's no review fee. I haven't assessed any further work, so I can't give a correction price on this call.

Answers and explanations, page 134

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The record supports the original toward-client direction, while the client reports that the finished lettering faces away. Acknowledge that mismatch specifically. The accepted 4:00 appointment is a review, not a promised correction.

E Conversation

The lettering faces the wrong way

The lettering faces the wrong way

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

remedy decision / completion promise / review fee / correction method / review confirmation / review appointment / viewing perspective / case note / service record / orientation mismatch

01 **Imani:** I'm calling about the lettering on my nails. I asked to read it facing toward me, but it's facing away.

02 **Alex:** I've found the [1] _____. It says toward the client, just as you've described.

03 **Imani:** Thank you. I don't want this treated as changing my mind. I explained the direction during the appointment.

04 **Alex:** I understand. You're reporting an [2] _____, not asking us to replace the original request with a new one.

05 **Imani:** Can Rosa look at it today? I can come back if there's an appointment.

06 **Alex:** She has a [3] _____ at four. She can look at the lettering with you and discuss what happens next.

07 **Imani:** Would I have to pay just to come back and show her the problem?

08 **Alex:** There's no [4] _____. I haven't assessed any further work, so I can't give a correction price on this call.

09 **Imani:** I see. Can you tell me how she'd change it, or does she need to see the nails first?

10 **Alex:** She needs to assess the [5] _____ with you first. I don't want to promise a procedure we haven't discussed.

Conversation continues on the next page.

The lettering faces the wrong way

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Imani:** Please don't start anything else without explaining it. I'd like to know exactly what's being proposed.

12 **Alex:** Certainly. A [6] _____ comes after that discussion. Booking the review doesn't commit you to further work.

13 **Imani:** And how long would I be there? I need to arrange the rest of my afternoon.

14 **Alex:** I can't make a [7] _____ for a correction yet. Four is the review time, not a guaranteed finish time.

15 **Imani:** All right, I'll take the four o'clock review. Please make the note specific, not just unhappy with nails.

16 **Alex:** The [8] _____ will say toward you requested and recorded, but finished lettering reported as facing away.

17 **Imani:** Exactly. The letters should be readable from where I'm sitting. Nothing has chipped; it's the direction.

18 **Alex:** I'll keep your [9] _____ clear. I won't substitute a wear problem for the concern you're actually reporting.

19 **Imani:** Thank you. Could you send me the time and Rosa's name so I can check them?

20 **Alex:** Yes. The [10] _____ is today at four with Rosa, no charge for the review. No correction or refund has been approved during this call.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. service record / **2.** orientation mismatch / **3.** review appointment / **4.** review fee / **5.** correction method / **6.** remedy decision / **7.** completion promise / **8.** case note / **9.** viewing perspective / **10.** review confirmation

Why these answers fit, page 135

F Check accuracy and scope

The lettering faces the wrong way

Return to the case

Client Imani contacts receptionist Alex because the line-art lettering on the finished nails faces away from the client. Imani requested lettering facing toward the client, and the service record confirms that original direction. A review with technician Rosa is available today at 4:00 with no review fee. Imani accepts that review. No correction method, correction price, refund, or completion time has been assessed or approved. Alex must recognize the documented mismatch without claiming that the no-fee review guarantees a free or immediate particular correction.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which concern should the case note identify?

A. A lettering-orientation mismatch
B. A confirmed product allergy
C. A reported chip that was never mentioned
D. A guaranteed removal procedure

2. Which confirmation is accurate after acceptance?

A. Today at 4:00 with Rosa for a no-fee review of the direction concern.
B. A full correction at 4:00 with every cost waived.
C. A refund already processed.
D. A new paid design unrelated to the original record.

Answers and explanations, page 136

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles and read the review arrangement. Stress no fee for the review, without promising a correction's price or finish time.

A specific acknowledgment prevents a circular complaint

When the record confirms a requested detail, acknowledge it directly rather than asking the client to defend the same preference repeatedly. Then separate the review arrangement from any remedy that still needs assessment. Clear limits are more useful than a vague promise to make everything right.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Confirm a different design review

The record says lettering should face away from the client, but the client reports it faces toward them. A no-fee review with Jo tomorrow at 11:00 is accepted. No correction method or price is agreed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

agreed / fee / away / 11:00

01 **Reception:** The recorded direction is [1] _____ from the client.

02 **Client:** The accepted review is tomorrow at [2] _____.

03 **Reception:** The review itself has no [3] _____.

04 **Reception:** No correction method is [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. away / **2.** 11:00 / **3.** fee / **4.** agreed

Why these answers fit, page 137

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The lettering faces the wrong way". Imani: "And how long would I be there? I need to arrange the rest of my afternoon." Alex: [missing response] Imani: "All right, I'll take the four o'clock review. Please make the note specific, not just unhappy with nails." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. There's no review fee. I haven't assessed any further work, so I can't give a correction price on this call.

B. She needs to assess the correction method with you first. I don't want to promise a procedure we haven't discussed.

C. I can't make a completion promise for a correction yet. Four is the review time, not a guaranteed finish time.

D. She has a review appointment at four. She can look at the lettering with you and discuss what happens next.

Answers and explanations, page 138

A Read the situation

LESSON 08 / SCHEDULING FOLLOW-UP AND HANDING OVER EXACT REQUESTS

Hand over the desired appearance, unknown existing product, and pending consultation without inventing removal time or an infill booking.

> **Friday is a request, not a booking**
>
> Technician Sora hands a client request to receptionist Malik. The client wants plain color next Friday at 10:00 and declines nail art. An existing product is present, but its identity is unknown. Reception must arrange a consultation before confirming removal duration or whether an infill is appropriate. Friday at 10:00 is only a requested time; no appointment has been accepted or booked. Malik takes responsibility for discussing consultation availability while keeping the product uncertainty and no-art preference explicit.

People: Sora, Nail technician; Malik, Receptionist.

Read the record

Choose one answer per question using the facts above.

1. What appearance does the client request?

A. Plain color with no nail art
B. Four decorated nails
C. A confirmed extension design
D. A specific removal method

2. What is unknown?

A. Whether any product is present
B. The requested day and time
C. The no-art preference
D. The identity of the existing product

3. What is Friday at 10:00?

A. A guaranteed removal completion time
B. A confirmed infill service
C. A requested time, not a booking
D. An accepted appointment

Answers and explanations, page 139

B Vocabulary in use

CORE TERMS

existing product
Material already on the client's nails before a new service.

identify the existing product

unidentified product
Existing material whose type or identity is not established.

record an unidentified product

previous provider
Professional or salon that performed an earlier service.

clarify the previous provider

removal duration
Time needed for removing an identified product under the actual process.

assess removal duration

file-off
Product-removal category involving controlled filing under professional procedures.

distinguish a file-off category

rebalance
Maintenance term for restoring enhancement structure as the nail grows.

discuss rebalance terminology

product identity
Exact identifying information about the material present.

confirm product identity

service history
Relevant record of earlier nail services and products.

review service history

removal consultation
Discussion and assessment before confirming a removal service.

arrange a removal consultation

soak-off
Product-removal category used for materials designed for the relevant solvent process.

clarify a soak-off category

infill
Maintenance service addressing growth in an existing enhancement when appropriate.

assess whether an infill is suitable

regrowth area
New growth visible near the base of an existing enhancement.

identify the regrowth area

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

existing product EXISTING PRODUCT

identify the existing product

Keep the meaning precise: Material already on the client's nails before a new service.

removal consultation REMOVAL CONSULTATION

arrange a removal consultation

Keep the meaning precise: Discussion and assessment before confirming a removal service.

B Precision and professional shorthand

EXTEND YOUR RANGE

maintenance appointment

Follow-up service whose scope depends on assessment.

clarify the maintenance appointment

declined option

Service element the client has explicitly not selected.

record the declined option

confirmed appointment

Booking with the relevant details agreed.

distinguish a confirmed appointment

consultation prerequisite

Consultation needed before confirming further service details.

explain the consultation prerequisite

handover owner

Person responsible for the next action after the handover.

name the handover owner

pending action

Next step that remains unfinished.

identify the pending action

plain-color request

Preference for color without added decorative art.

preserve the plain-color request

requested time

Preferred slot that has not necessarily been offered or accepted.

record the requested time

availability discussion

Conversation about possible times, not automatic acceptance.

hold an availability discussion

provisional duration

Tentative time estimate not yet a firm service allocation.

avoid an unsupported provisional duration

client confirmation

Explicit acceptance of the relevant appointment or service details.

obtain client confirmation

status correction

Amendment replacing an inaccurate status with the true one.

make a status correction

Say it in context

Stress the highlighted expression. Keep the surrounding words connected; pause at the end of the phrase.

regrowth area REGROWTH AREA

identify the regrowth area

Keep the meaning precise: New growth visible near the base of an existing enhancement.

confirmed appointment CONFIRMED APPOINTMENT

distinguish a confirmed appointment

Keep the meaning precise: Booking with the relevant details agreed.

C Phrases that move the work forward

Open the handover
I have a plain-color request with an unidentified existing product.

Record the requested slot
Friday at 10:00 is the preferred time.

Name the uncertainty
We do not yet know which product is present.

Explain the prerequisite
A consultation is needed before confirming removal time.

Keep infill open
Whether an infill is appropriate still needs assessment.

Assign the next action
Reception will discuss consultation availability.

Preserve the declined option
Please keep no nail art explicit in the record.

Correct the status
Change confirmed to requested if that entry was made prematurely.

State the appearance
The client wants plain color and no nail art.

Prevent a booking assumption
That time is requested, not booked.

Keep history accurate
Unknown product does not mean no existing product.

Avoid a standard-time guess
I cannot assign a removal duration from the current information.

Separate service categories
Removal and infill are not the same booking decision.

Avoid inventing acceptance
No appointment date has been accepted yet.

Ask for a read-back
Can you repeat the request and the unresolved details?

Close the handover
Consultation pending; removal time and infill unconfirmed.

Precision in real exchanges

Purpose: Prevent a booking assumption
Useful wording: That time is requested, not booked.

Purpose: Name the uncertainty
Useful wording: We do not yet know which product is present.

D Choose the response that fits

Choose one response for each situation. Preserve the facts, the decision boundary, and the purpose of the exchange.

1. Which handover is accurate?

A. No existing product because its name is unknown.
B. Nail art approved during reception handover.
C. Plain color, no art, Friday 10:00 requested; existing product unidentified.
D. Infill booked Friday with standard removal time.

2. What must precede confirmation of removal time?

A. Assuming every product removes identically
B. Selecting the shortest available slot
C. Treating Friday as already booked
D. The consultation needed to assess the existing product and service

3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Relevant record of earlier nail services and products. Which term fits?

A. file-off
B. handover owner
C. service history
D. declined option

D Choose the response that fits / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Friday is a request, not a booking". Sora: "Thank you. Friday at ten is the time the client requested, but we did not offer a confirmed appointment or get acceptance of a slot." Malik: [missing response] Sora: "Exactly. We also cannot assume what removal involves. The client says there is product on the nails but cannot identify it." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will separate the plain-color request from the service assessment. Is nail art wanted, or should the record explicitly say that it has been declined?

B. Then the requested time stays requested. I will not enter it as a booking just because the client named a day and an hour.

C. I will be the handover owner for the availability discussion. Taking responsibility does not change the unbooked status or resolve the product uncertainty.

D. An infill is not automatically the right booking just because it is a familiar term. Its suitability still needs assessment through the consultation.

Answers and explanations, page 139

> **One useful distinction**
>
> The client wants plain color, no nail art, and Friday at 10:00. Those are a preference and a requested time, not a booking. The unidentified existing product means removal duration and infill suitability cannot be confirmed from the supplied facts.

E Conversation

Friday is a request, not a booking

Friday is a request, not a booking

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

client confirmation / removal duration / consultation prerequisite / handover owner / plain-color request / requested time / declined option / pending action / infill / unidentified product

01 **Sora:** I need to hand over a follow-up request. The client wants plain color next Friday at ten, but there is an existing product we have not identified.

02 **Malik:** I will separate the [1] _____ from the service assessment. Is nail art wanted, or should the record explicitly say that it has been declined?

03 **Sora:** No art. The client specifically asked for plain color, even on the accent nails.

04 **Malik:** I will preserve that [2] _____. Plain color and no nail art should remain together in the appearance note.

05 **Sora:** Thank you. Friday at ten is the time the client requested, but we did not offer a confirmed appointment or get acceptance of a slot.

06 **Malik:** Then the [3] _____ stays requested. I will not enter it as a booking just because the client named a day and an hour.

07 **Sora:** Exactly. We also cannot assume what removal involves. The client says there is product on the nails but cannot identify it.

08 **Malik:** I will record an [4] _____, not no product. That distinction matters before anyone promises a standard removal time.

09 **Sora:** Could you arrange the consultation first? We don't know enough to book a removal slot yet.

10 **Malik:** The [5] _____ is clear. I will discuss consultation availability rather than confirm an unassessed removal or infill service.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Friday is a request, not a booking

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Sora:** Good. The client may use infill as a general word for the next visit, but we have not established whether that is appropriate here.

12 **Malik:** An [6] _____ is not automatically the right booking just because it is a familiar term. Its suitability still needs assessment through the consultation.

13 **Sora:** Please don't quote the usual removal time. We still don't know what we're dealing with.

14 **Malik:** I will leave [7] _____ unconfirmed. The product and relevant service need to be understood before a meaningful time allocation is promised.

15 **Sora:** Could you read back the handover now? I want to catch any wording that makes the Friday preference sound more definite than it is.

16 **Malik:** Plain color, no nail art, Friday at ten requested but unbooked, and existing product unidentified. The [8] _____ is to discuss a consultation before confirming removal time or infill suitability.

17 **Sora:** Yes. Please offer consultation times and get the client's agreement before sending a booking confirmation.

18 **Malik:** I will be the [9] _____ for the availability discussion. Taking responsibility does not change the unbooked status or resolve the product uncertainty.

19 **Sora:** Thanks. Explain that we need to check the existing material so we can plan the right appointment.

20 **Malik:** I will explain the purpose and seek [10] _____ for any offered slot. The record will remain precise: request received, consultation pending, and no removal duration or infill booking confirmed.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. plain-color request / **2.** declined option / **3.** requested time / **4.** unidentified product / **5.** consultation prerequisite / **6.** infill / **7.** removal duration / **8.** pending action / **9.** handover owner / **10.** client confirmation

Why these answers fit, page 140

F Check accuracy and scope

Friday is a request, not a booking

Return to the case

Technician Sora hands a client request to receptionist Malik. The client wants plain color next Friday at 10:00 and declines nail art. An existing product is present, but its identity is unknown. Reception must arrange a consultation before confirming removal duration or whether an infill is appropriate. Friday at 10:00 is only a requested time; no appointment has been accepted or booked. Malik takes responsibility for discussing consultation availability while keeping the product uncertainty and no-art preference explicit.

Choose one answer per question. Use the case facts and keep any uncertainty or limits intact.

1. Which phrase makes an unsupported commitment?

A. No nail art is requested.
B. Your infill is confirmed for Friday at ten.
C. Friday at ten is your requested time.
D. Reception will discuss consultation availability.

2. What does reception taking responsibility mean?

A. Removal duration is automatically confirmed.
B. Reception owns the next availability discussion.
C. Consultation has already been completed.
D. Existing product is now identified.

Answers and explanations, page 142

Listen for the distinction

Switch roles. Stress product present but unidentified and Friday requested but unbooked.

Do not let a convenient slot decide the service

A client may ask for a familiar time before the existing product or needed service is understood. Record the requested time without treating it as a confirmed slot. An accurate handover keeps the next colleague from promising a duration or infill based on an unidentified product.

F Say it / transfer to a new case

Hand over another unbooked request

A client requests plain color on Tuesday at 2:00, with no nail art. Existing product is unidentified. Reception owns the consultation availability discussion before removal time or infill suitability can be confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. With a partner, read alternate roles, then switch. Studying alone, read both roles and pause before each response.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

reception / unidentified / Tuesday / confirmed

01 **Technician:** The requested day is [1] _____.

02 **Reception:** Existing product remains [2] _____.

03 **Technician:** The next availability discussion belongs to [3] _____.

04 **Reception:** Removal time cannot yet be [4] _____.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. Tuesday / **2.** unidentified / **3.** reception / **4.** confirmed

Why these answers fit, page 142

Rebuild the exchange

Choose the missing response. Read the completed three-turn exchange aloud, changing roles on the second reading.

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Friday is a request, not a booking". Sora: "Please don't quote the usual removal time. We still don't know what we're dealing with." Malik: [missing response] Sora: "Could you read back the handover now? I want to catch any wording that makes the Friday preference sound more definite than it is." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will be the handover owner for the availability discussion. Taking responsibility does not change the unbooked status or resolve the product uncertainty.

B. Then the requested time stays requested. I will not enter it as a booking just because the client named a day and an hour.

C. I will leave removal duration unconfirmed. The product and relevant service need to be understood before a meaningful time allocation is promised.

D. An infill is not automatically the right booking just because it is a familiar term. Its suitability still needs assessment through the consultation.

Answers and explanations, page 143

Review 4 / Meaning and context

Use language from the lessons you have completed. Choose one answer per question.

> **Case file**
>
> Revisit "Handling a chip or design concern" and "Scheduling follow-up and handing over exact requests". Choose precise terminology, then reconstruct the missing responses using both neighboring turns. The final two questions also revisit earlier conversations.

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Oriented so the relevant front faces the named viewer. Which term fits?

A. facing toward
B. wear concern
C. refund approval
D. design brief

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Product-removal category used for materials designed for the relevant solvent process. Which term fits?

A. consultation prerequisite
B. maintenance appointment
C. soak-off
D. existing product

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Tidy is not confirmed ready". Maya: "All right. For the client who's here, I'll say we have another station available now." Owen: [missing response] Maya: "Who confirmed two? I'd like to put the name in the note so the next receptionist can see it." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Thanks. Keep that readiness handover for the next receptionist too, so nobody has to guess from what the room looks like.
B. Yes, that's the available alternative. Three needs to stay out of use until the remaining checks are finished and confirmed.
C. That works. Station two is confirmed ready; we don't need to give the client a detailed account of the unfinished checks elsewhere.
D. Not by itself. The readiness check follows our actual process. An empty table doesn't establish that the tools or other requirements are ready.

Review 4 / Meaning and context / continued

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Friday is a request, not a booking". Sora: "Yes. Please offer consultation times and get the client's agreement before sending a booking confirmation." Malik: [missing response] Sora: "Thanks. Explain that we need to check the existing material so we can plan the right appointment." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will be the handover owner for the availability discussion. Taking responsibility does not change the unbooked status or resolve the product uncertainty.

B. An infill is not automatically the right booking just because it is a familiar term. Its suitability still needs assessment through the consultation.

C. I will leave removal duration unconfirmed. The product and relevant service need to be understood before a meaningful time allocation is promised.

D. Then the requested time stays requested. I will not enter it as a booking just because the client named a day and an hour.

Answers and explanations, page 150

Language for the next case

Match the system, not the watts

input rating

The 36 W input rating concerns electrical power; matching it does not establish that lamp B meets system G's curing requirements.

Jo: Not from the input rating alone. We need the specified product-and-lamp information, not just the same number on the electrical label.

compatibility

Compatibility between the exact lamp and product system is unverified; a shared input rating cannot supply the missing evidence.

Jo: Then compatibility is unverified. Please don't start applying G while we try to resolve that gap.

model identity

Model identity names the actual lamp; a similar case or display does not make two models interchangeable.

Jo: Good. The model identity matters more than the shape of the case. Similar-looking lamps need not deliver the same curing conditions.

timer

The timer shows elapsed or selected time, not proof that an unspecified lamp supplies the required light conditions.

Jo: Correct. The timer doesn't establish the required light conditions. Don't create a substitute protocol by matching seconds or adding extra time.

surface

The surface appearance does not independently verify curing throughout the product or replace the specified system instructions.

Jo: No. A firm-looking surface isn't a complete cure check. We follow the actual system instructions and training rather than a visual guess.

UV-free

UV-free cannot be inferred from LED; nail-curing LED systems may emit ultraviolet light.

Jo: Right. LED identifies the light-source technology, not a guarantee of UV-free output. Use the exact lamp information instead of that shortcut.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Match the system, not the watts

Fictional pre-service check: gel system G requires the identified L4 lamp under its current instructions. L4 is unavailable. Borrowed lamp B displays the same 36 W input rating, but no compatibility documentation is available. No product has been applied. Technician Mina and lead Jo review the proposed substitution; this exercise supplies no curing procedure or exposure time.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

input rating / timer / model identity / surface / UV-free / compatibility

01 **Mina:** Our L4 isn't available, but I can borrow lamp B. Both labels say thirty-six watts. Does that make B a suitable replacement for system G?

02 **Jo:** Not from the [1] _____ alone. We need the specified product-and-lamp information, not just the same number on the electrical label.

03 **Mina:** The current instruction for G names L4. I haven't found any document that lists B for this system.

04 **Jo:** Then [2] _____ is unverified. Please don't start applying G while we try to resolve that gap.

05 **Mina:** Nothing has been applied. I wanted to check first because the client is waiting and B looks very similar.

06 **Jo:** Good. The [3] _____ matters more than the shape of the case. Similar-looking lamps need not deliver the same curing conditions.

07 **Mina:** B also has a countdown display. I could select the same time, but that wouldn't prove it's the same exposure, would it?

08 **Jo:** Correct. The [4] _____ doesn't establish the required light conditions. Don't create a substitute protocol by matching seconds or adding extra time.

09 **Mina:** I've heard people say that if a gel looks firm, it must be fully cured. Is appearance enough to check that?

10 **Jo:** No. A firm-looking [5] _____ isn't a complete cure check. We follow the actual system instructions and training rather than a visual guess.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Match the system, not the watts

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Mina:** And the word LED on the box doesn't automatically mean there's no ultraviolet light involved?

12 **Jo:** Right. LED identifies the light-source technology, not a guarantee of [6] _____ output. Use the exact lamp information instead of that shortcut.

13 **Mina:** I'll tell reception we're checking equipment suitability before offering this gel service, not that the client has caused a delay.

14 **Jo:** Yes. Give a clear update and discuss an appropriate alternative or rebooking through our process. Don't promise that a different service is already suitable or accepted.

15 **Mina:** If someone finds another L4, does the model match settle every readiness check automatically?

16 **Jo:** No. Its condition, required checks, and correct use still matter. A matching model answers only one part of the equipment question.

17 **Mina:** So today's note should say L4 unavailable, B same input rating but compatibility unverified, and no application started.

18 **Jo:** Exactly. Do not write lamp B approved or system G completed. We have only reviewed a proposed substitution.

19 **Mina:** I'll keep B out of this planned service until the relevant information and approval are obtained. I won't improvise a curing time.

20 **Jo:** Thank you. Ask for the actual manufacturer guidance and follow our equipment process. The schedule can't supply the missing technical evidence.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. input rating / **2.** compatibility / **3.** model identity / **4.** timer / **5.** surface / **6.** UV-free

Why these answers fit, page 152

A larger number does not approve a lamp

Fictional system H specifies lamp M2. An available M9 is rated 48 W, while M2 is rated 36 W. No compatibility evidence for M9 is supplied. No product has been applied; no alternative procedure is approved.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

M2 / M9 / rating / unverified

01 **Technician:** The lamp named by system H is [1] _____ .

02 **Lead:** The available but unverified model is [2] _____ .

03 **Technician:** Forty-eight watts is the substitute's input [3] _____ .

04 **Lead:** Compatibility with H remains [4] _____ .

CHECK THE GAPS

1. M2 / **2.** M9 / **3.** rating / **4.** unverified

Why these answers fit, page 152

Keep the distinction audible

Read a product-and-lamp record without confusing electrical power, visible appearance, or a timer with verified curing conditions.

Language for the next case

A storage box is not a process

disinfection

Disinfection is a required process completed for A after cleaning; the cleaned-only label on B does not establish it.

Ravi: Set A has completed the required disinfection and the other checks. It's the only set confirmed ready in this record.

cleaned only

Cleaned only means that stage is recorded for B; the remaining required processing and confirmation are not complete.

Ravi: Here, cleaned only is an intermediate status. It doesn't mean the remaining processing or readiness confirmation has happened.

storage

The supplied UV cabinet is for storage only; placing tools inside cannot replace the required disinfection process.

Ravi: No. This cabinet is storage only. It isn't a substitute for the required tool processing.

cross-contamination

Cross-contamination can transfer unwanted material or microorganisms between used and prepared items; separate handling preserves the distinction.

Ravi: Yes. Keeping those flows separate helps prevent cross-contamination. Don't mix used tools into a ready set because the tray has space.

single-use

Single-use describes the intended use limit; an unworn appearance does not make the used board reusable.

Ravi: No. Its single-use designation still applies. Handle it under the disposal procedure rather than relabel it as reusable.

Sterilization

Sterilization is a distinct validated process, including elimination of bacterial spores; no such process is established by this record.

Ravi: No. Sterilization isn't established here. Say it completed the required cleaning, disinfection, and storage checks, not that it is sterile.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

A storage box is not a process

Fictional stock check: reusable metal set A has completed the site's required cleaning, disinfection, and storage checks and is confirmed ready. Set B is cleaned only. Set C is used and unprocessed. A used single-use emery board is also present. The salon's UV cabinet is for storage only. No chemical procedure or sterilization process is supplied.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

cleaned only / single-use / cross-contamination / storage / Sterilization / disinfection

01 **Lena:** Before I take a tool set, can you check these labels with me? A says ready, B says cleaned, and C is in the used area.

02 **Ravi:** Set A has completed the required [1] _____ and the other checks. It's the only set confirmed ready in this record.

03 **Lena:** B looks just as shiny as A. I nearly picked it up because I read cleaned as meaning everything was finished.

04 **Ravi:** Here, [2] _____ is an intermediate status. It doesn't mean the remaining processing or readiness confirmation has happened.

05 **Lena:** Could I put B in the UV cabinet and then mark it ready? I thought that cabinet did the next stage.

06 **Ravi:** No. This cabinet is [3] _____ only. It isn't a substitute for the required tool processing.

07 **Lena:** Then B needs to stay identified as incomplete, and C needs to stay in the used-item area for the correct handling.

08 **Ravi:** Yes. Keeping those flows separate helps prevent [4] _____. Don't mix used tools into a ready set because the tray has space.

09 **Lena:** What about this emery board? It's marked single use, but it doesn't look worn out. Could it go with B for processing?

10 **Ravi:** No. Its [5] _____ designation still applies. Handle it under the disposal procedure rather than relabel it as reusable.

Conversation continues on the next page.

A storage box is not a process

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Lena:** For the metal sets, should I describe A as sterile when I tell the next technician it's ready?

12 **Ravi:** No. [6] _____ isn't established here. Say it completed the required cleaning, disinfection, and storage checks, not that it is sterile.

13 **Lena:** So ready is a specific process status. It isn't a claim that any item in any box is completely free of every microorganism.

14 **Ravi:** Correct. Use the actual completed record and the site's applicable requirements. Don't add a broader claim the record doesn't support.

15 **Lena:** If we need B later, should I copy the timing from yesterday's different disinfectant into today's record?

16 **Ravi:** No. Follow the current instructions for the actual product, tool, and workplace requirements. This stock conversation doesn't provide a mixing ratio, contact time, or processing method.

17 **Lena:** Understood. I'll take A for the planned service, keep B marked cleaned only, and leave C clearly identified as used.

18 **Ravi:** And the used single-use board goes through the disposal route, not the reusable-tool route. That keeps all four statuses distinct.

19 **Lena:** I'll tell the next person which set is ready by letter, rather than saying the tools on the counter are fine.

20 **Ravi:** Good. A is confirmed ready; B and C are not. The cabinet location and a shiny appearance can't replace those specific records.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. disinfection / **2.** cleaned only / **3.** storage / **4.** cross-contamination / **5.** single-use / **6.** Sterilization

Why these answers fit, page 154

Keep the tool labels distinct

Reusable set D is used and unprocessed; E is cleaned only; F has completed required cleaning, disinfection, and storage checks and is confirmed ready. A used file is marked single use. The cabinet is storage only; no sterilization is recorded.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

only / disposal / F / storage

01 **Technician:** The only confirmed-ready set is [1] _____ .

02 **Assistant:** Set E is cleaned [2] _____ .

03 **Technician:** The used single-use file follows the [3] _____ procedure.

04 **Assistant:** The cabinet provides [4] _____, not the missing processing.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. F / **2.** only / **3.** disposal / **4.** storage

Why these answers fit, page 154

Keep the distinction audible

Report reusable-tool and single-use-item status without treating tidiness, storage, or a UV cabinet as disinfection.

Language for the next case

Which edge gets the accent?

smile line

The smile line is the curved boundary separating the contrasting tip from the pink area in sample A.

Ana: Yes, let's map the appearance first. A has a crisp smile line between the pink area and the white tip.

ombre

Ombre is a gradual blended transition; Sol instead chooses the crisp division shown in sample A.

Ana: Then C's ombre effect isn't part of the request. We'll keep that separate from the sharp-edged tip on A.

reverse French

The label here identifies the base-crescent design in B; the specified location, not the label alone, settles the request.

Ana: For this sample, reverse French labels the base crescent. I'll record its location explicitly because the label alone can be misunderstood.

ring fingernails

The ring fingernails receive B instead of A; one on each hand gives two accent nails.

Ana: So both ring fingernails get the silver base crescent and no white French tip. Is that right?

eight

Ten fingernails minus the two ring-finger exceptions leaves eight receiving sample A.

Ana: That makes eight with A and two with B. We're counting ten nails in total, not adding two extra decorations to all ten.

placement map

A placement map assigns the chosen design to specific nails, preventing a correct count from landing on the wrong fingers.

Ana: I'll make the placement map by hand and finger. The ring finger is between the middle and little fingers.

Read the phrases aloud. Then complete the conversation on the following pages using the word bank.

Conversation

Which edge gets the accent?

Three fictional samples: A has a pink base and crisp white French tip; B has a silver crescent near the nail base, labelled reverse French; C blends pink into white with no crisp dividing line. Client Sol selects A on eight nails and B on both ring fingernails. All ten stay short; no extensions or application method are agreed.

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once; some entries contain several words.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

eight / ombre / ring fingernails / smile line / reverse French / placement map

01 **Sol:** I like the white edge on A, but I'd like the silver detail from B on my ring fingers. Can we combine those looks?

02 **Ana:** Yes, let's map the appearance first. A has a crisp [1] _____ between the pink area and the white tip.

03 **Sol:** That's the line I like. I don't want the white fading gradually into the pink like it does on C.

04 **Ana:** Then C's [2] _____ effect isn't part of the request. We'll keep that separate from the sharp-edged tip on A.

05 **Sol:** B says reverse French. I mean that silver crescent near the base, not silver at the far end of the nail.

06 **Ana:** For this sample, [3] _____ labels the base crescent. I'll record its location explicitly because the label alone can be misunderstood.

07 **Sol:** Good. On the ring fingers I want B instead of A, not both decorations layered onto the same nail.

08 **Ana:** So both [4] _____ get the silver base crescent and no white French tip. Is that right?

09 **Sol:** Yes, one on each hand. Every other fingernail gets the pink base and white tip from A.

10 **Ana:** That makes [5] _____ with A and two with B. We're counting ten nails in total, not adding two extra decorations to all ten.

Conversation continues on the next page.

Which edge gets the accent?

CONVERSATION / CONTINUED

11 **Sol:** Exactly. Please don't put the silver on the middle fingers by mistake. These two ring fingers are the exceptions.

12 **Ana:** I'll make the [6] _____ by hand and finger. The ring finger is between the middle and little fingers.

13 **Sol:** And keep them short. I like the pattern, not the longer length of the display pieces.

14 **Ana:** Short length remains part of your request. Selecting a design sample doesn't request extensions, and we'll confirm the actual length separately.

15 **Sol:** When I hold my hands out to you, my left is on your right. Could that confuse the note?

16 **Ana:** We'll use your left and your right throughout. For this design both ring fingers match, but the same habit matters when a design is different on each hand.

17 **Sol:** Can you read all of it back before we choose products or start any work?

18 **Ana:** Eight pink-and-white French-tip nails with a crisp line; silver base crescents instead on your two ring fingernails; short length, no added extensions requested.

19 **Sol:** Yes. No blended C effect and no extra white tip on the ring fingers. That's the combination I want.

20 **Ana:** I've recorded those exclusions with the map. We'll discuss the remaining service details from that precise design, without letting a style name replace the placement.

CHECK THE GAPS

1. smile line / **2.** ombre / **3.** reverse French / **4.** ring fingernails / **5.** eight / **6.** placement map

Why these answers fit, page 156

Count the exceptions, not just the hands

For ten fingernails, sample A is selected everywhere except the client's left thumb and the right index and middle fingernails. Those three receive sample B instead, not in addition. No other exceptions are agreed.

Complete the exchange using each phrase once. Read both roles, then switch roles and repeat with the bank covered.

WORD AND PHRASE BANK

three / right hand / seven / left thumb

01 **Technician:** Sample A appears on [1] _____ nails.

02 **Client:** Sample B replaces A on [2] _____ nails.

03 **Technician:** The single exception on the left is the [3] _____ .

04 **Client:** The index and middle exceptions are on my [4] _____ .

CHECK THE GAPS

1. seven / **2.** three / **3.** left thumb / **4.** right hand

Why these answers fit, page 156

Keep the distinction audible

Turn style labels into an exact ten-nail design map, keeping tip, base, and blended effects distinct.

01 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What length does Zoe want?

B. The current short length retained

Zoe explicitly wants the existing short length rather than the long reference.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A2. What was booked?

B. An overlay

The booking says overlay even though Zoe uses another label in conversation.

Return to the exercise, page 4

A3. What does the reference image authorize by itself?

D. No automatic length change

An image starts the discussion but does not replace explicit agreement about length.

Return to the exercise, page 4

D / Response choices

D1. Which question resolves the key ambiguity?

B. Do you want added length, or your current short length kept?

The question directly checks the client's actual length preference rather than assuming the label.

Return to the exercise, page 8

D2. Which summary is accurate?

B. Natural-nail overlay discussion at current short length, with no extensions requested.

The summary preserves the clarified length and leaves other service decisions open.

Return to the exercise, page 8

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Part of the nail extending beyond its attachment at the fingertip. Which term fits?

B. free edge

A Not here. full set: Common service label whose intended scope must be confirmed. The usual combination is "clarify the full-set request".

B Correct. free edge: Part of the nail extending beyond its attachment at the fingertip. The usual combination is "discuss the free edge".

C Not here. length preference: Client's stated choice about how long the result should be. The usual combination is "record the length preference".

D Not here. lacquer: Conventional nail-polish category, distinct from gel polish. The usual combination is "identify nail lacquer".

Return to the exercise, page 8

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The picture is long; the request is short". Zoe: "Good. I like the look in the photograph, but the long nails would get in my way at work." Lin: [missing response] Zoe: "So an overlay and extensions aren't the same thing? I'd like to know what the menu means next time." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. We'll use the reference image to discuss the look, not copy every feature. No extra length is requested.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Zoe says: "So an overlay and extensions aren't the same thing? I'd like to know what the menu means next time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Zoe says: "Could you repeat the main point before we start? I want to be sure I explained it properly." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Zoe says: "I'm here for a full set. I brought this picture, but please don't make them this long. I want to keep my own length." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Lin's response in turn 6. It connects Zoe's preceding point with Zoe's follow-up. The image supplies visual ideas but does not replace Zoe's explicit decision to retain short nails.

Return to the exercise, page 8

E / Conversation

1. overlay

Turn 2. Overlay is the booked service; the word alone does not authorize extensions or choose a product.

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. service label

Turn 4. A service label names an appointment, but checking the desired result resolves differences in how people use it.

3. reference image

Turn 6. The image supplies visual ideas but does not replace Zoe's explicit decision to retain short nails.

4. Extensions

Turn 8. Extensions add length beyond the existing natural nail, which Zoe has declined in this case.

5. nail plate

Turn 10. The plate is the hard visible nail; the nail bed is the tissue beneath it.

6. Builder gel

Turn 12. Builder gel is used to create enhancement structure; gel polish names a color-coating category, not an identical service.

7. product system

Turn 14. The product system remains unselected even after the length preference has been clarified.

8. retained length

Turn 16. Retained length means the existing short length Zoe wants preserved rather than extended.

9. read-back

Turn 18. The read-back lets Zoe verify that her stated preference has not been replaced by the long reference.

10. length preference

Turn 20. The length preference is settled while other service choices remain open and no work has begun.

Return to the conversation, page 10

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which product statement is supported?

D. Product selection still needs clarification.

The case does not select a system or bypass the normal consultation.

Return to the exercise, page 12

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which response avoids blaming the client for terminology?

C. Service names vary; let us confirm the result you want.

The response invites clarification respectfully instead of treating vocabulary knowledge as a prerequisite.

Return to the exercise, page 12

F / Guided speaking

1. medium

Technician: The current medium length should be retained.

Turn 1. Medium is the existing length the client explicitly wants to keep.

2. extensions

Client: No extensions are requested.

Turn 2. The long image does not change the client's no-added-length request.

3. open

Technician: Product choice remains open.

Turn 3. A length preference does not select the product system or establish suitability.

4. begun

Client: No work has begun.

Turn 4. Clarification takes place before the service starts in the supplied scenario.

Return to the conversation, page 13

01 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The picture is long; the request is short". Zoe: "I haven't chosen a material yet. I'd like you to explain the options before we settle on one." Lin: [missing response] Zoe: "Please keep that short-length request on the booking. I don't want the picture confusing anyone else who helps today." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Certainly. The product system is still open. Keeping the nails short doesn't answer that question by itself.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Zoe says: "I'm here for a full set. I brought this picture, but please don't make them this long. I want to keep my own length." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Zoe says: "Good. I like the look in the photograph, but the long nails would get in my way at work." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Lin's response in turn 14. It connects Zoe's preceding point with Zoe's follow-up. The product system remains unselected even after the length preference has been clarified.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Zoe says: "So an overlay and extensions aren't the same thing? I'd like to know what the menu means next time." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 13

02 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What practical requirement does Amara state?

A. A short result for keyboard work

The client wants short nails because of the way they use a keyboard.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A2. Which sample is short in this case?

A. The squoval sample

The brief explicitly contrasts a short squoval sample with a long almond sample.

Return to the exercise, page 14

A3. What does Amara choose for discussion?

B. The short squoval appearance

The choice concerns the sample appearance, not a technique or durability guarantee.

Return to the exercise, page 14

D / Response choices

D1. Which comparison is accurate?

A. This almond sample is long and tapered; this squoval sample is short with softened corners.

The comparison stays with the supplied visible features and avoids universal claims.

Return to the exercise, page 18

D2. Which question best clarifies the next detail?

D. What length reference shall we agree on for your actual nails?

The exact practical length remains to be clarified on the client's actual nails.

Return to the exercise, page 18

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Shape with a straighter free edge and more defined corners. Which term fits?

B. square

A Not here. practical requirement: Everyday need affecting the client's preference. The usual combination is "record the practical requirement".

B Correct. square: Shape with a straighter free edge and more defined corners. The usual combination is "identify the square shape".

C Not here. breakage: Breaking of a nail or enhancement, not prevented by a verbal guarantee. The usual combination is "avoid a breakage guarantee".

D Not here. tapered sides: Side outlines that narrow toward the tip. The usual combination is "compare tapered sides".

Return to the exercise, page 18

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "A shape that fits the working day". Amara: "What is the name of the shorter one beside it? The end looks straighter, but the corners do not look sharply square." Kai: [missing response] Amara: "I think the shorter one is closer. Could we use that shape without copying the long sample?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. That is the squoval sample. It combines a straighter end with softened corners, and the example here is short.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Amara says: "Yes. I like the tapered shape, but that length would make typing awkward for me." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Amara says: "I think the shorter one is closer. Could we use that shape without copying the long sample?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Kai's response in turn 6. It connects Amara's preceding point with Amara's follow-up. Squoval describes the straighter edge with softened corners shown in the shorter alternative sample.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Amara says: "Good. Please keep the softened corners in the discussion too. That is part of what I like about the second sample." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 18

E / Conversation

1. practical requirement

Turn 2. Practical requirement is the client's need for short nails during keyboard work, which should remain central to the comparison.

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. almond

Turn 4. Almond identifies the sample's narrowing outline and rounded tip, separate from the long length shown in this particular example.

3. squoval

Turn 6. Squoval describes the straighter edge with softened corners shown in the shorter alternative sample.

4. silhouettes

Turn 8. Silhouettes are the visible outer outlines, not instructions about which product or technique must be used.

5. comfort guarantee

Turn 10. Comfort guarantee would promise a daily-use outcome that the sample alone cannot establish for this client.

6. breakage

Turn 12. Breakage is a possible outcome that cannot be ruled out merely by choosing a named shape or looking at a display.

7. preferred outline

Turn 14. Preferred outline is the squoval appearance Amara chooses for discussion, while rejecting the long sample's length.

8. length reference

Turn 16. Length reference is the specific example or measurement to confirm on the actual nails, beyond the broad word short.

9. Softened corners

Turn 18. Softened corners distinguish the chosen squoval appearance from a more sharply square outline in this comparison.

10. suitability assessment

Turn 20. Suitability assessment remains part of the normal professional process; selecting an appearance does not establish a method or guaranteed performance.

Return to the conversation, page 20

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which promise is unsupported?

B. This shape will never cause discomfort or break.

Neither comfort nor breakage prevention is established by the visual sample.

Return to the exercise, page 22

F2. What does the selected sample establish?

D. A preferred appearance for discussion

The client selects the visible direction while assessment and exact details remain open.

Return to the exercise, page 22

F / Guided speaking

1. round

Technician: The preferred shape is round.

Turn 1. The client chooses the round appearance from the two supplied samples.

2. short

Client: My practical priority is short length.

Turn 2. Short length is the stated preference for keyboard work.

3. measurement

Technician: The exact measurement still needs agreement.

Turn 3. The broad length preference does not supply a specific agreed measurement.

4. breakage

Client: No guarantee against breakage has been made.

Turn 4. The visual choice does not establish that the nails cannot break.

Return to the conversation, page 23

02 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "A shape that fits the working day". Amara: "Then let us use the short squoval as the appearance I prefer. I do not want the long almond length copied." Kai: [missing response] Amara: "How short do you mean on my nails? Could you show me before you start?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will record the preferred outline and your short-length priority together. That keeps the visual choice connected to the practical reason you gave.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Amara says: "Does squoval mean it won't break? A friend told me it was the strongest shape." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Kai's response in turn 14. It connects Amara's preceding point with Amara's follow-up. Preferred outline is the squoval appearance Amara chooses for discussion, while rejecting the long sample's length.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Amara says: "Good. Please keep the softened corners in the discussion too. That is part of what I like about the second sample." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Amara says: "Yes, short with those softer corners. Let's check the actual length together." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 23

03 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which appearance does Dana want?

A. Sheer pink with low shine

Dana wants the pink and transparency of the swatch but a lower-shine finish.

Return to the exercise, page 26

A2. What should remain visible?

D. The natural nail line

The client specifically wants the nail line visible through the color.

Return to the exercise, page 26

A3. Which product category is booked?

D. Neither lacquer nor gel polish is specified

The booking leaves the product category unspecified, so it requires clarification.

Return to the exercise, page 26

D / Response choices

D1. Which statement explains the client's request?

B. Sheer concerns visibility through the color; matte concerns shine.

Coverage and finish are independent appearance dimensions in this consultation.

Return to the exercise, page 30

D2. Which swatch feature is not wanted?

C. Its glossy finish

The client likes the color and transparency but asks for low shine.

Return to the exercise, page 30

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Subtle underlying color character. Which term fits?

B. undertone

A Not here. sheen: Degree of reflected shine. The usual combination is "describe the sheen".

B Correct. undertone: Subtle underlying color character. The usual combination is "compare undertones".

C Not here. color coat: Layer providing the selected color effect. The usual combination is "identify the color coat".

D Not here. translucency: Degree to which light and underlying detail show through. The usual combination is "describe translucency".

Return to the exercise, page 30

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Sheer pink, without the shine". Dana: "Oh, I thought sheer meant shiny. The sheer samples I looked at all seemed glossy." Noor: [missing response] Dana: "Then this pink is right, and the transparency is right. It's the shiny surface I'd like changed." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Those samples combine two features. Their finish is glossy, but their coverage is sheer.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Dana says: "Then this pink is right, and the transparency is right. It's the shiny surface I'd like changed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Dana says: "Yes. I want some color, just not a solid block that hides the nail underneath." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Dana says: "I want matte pink, like this sample. I like seeing a little of the nail through it, but I don't want it so shiny." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Noor's response in turn 6. It connects Dana's preceding point with Dana's follow-up. Finish describes the surface appearance, which can be discussed separately from coverage.

Return to the exercise, page 30

E / Conversation

1. coverage

Turn 2. Coverage concerns how much underlying nail detail is concealed, not the amount of reflected shine.

2. sheer

Turn 4. Sheer coverage allows some underlying detail to show through a tinted color.

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

3. finish

Turn 6. Finish describes the surface appearance, which can be discussed separately from coverage.

4. matte

Turn 8. Matte identifies Dana's requested low-shine surface, unlike the glossy reference.

5. Opaque

Turn 10. Opaque means the underlying nail is concealed; it does not simply mean the color is dark.

6. nail line

Turn 12. The nail line is the underlying detail Dana wants to retain through the sheer pink coverage.

7. product category

Turn 14. The booking specifies neither lacquer nor gel polish, so the appearance request cannot settle that choice.

8. product system

Turn 16. The product system is still to be selected through consultation, not inferred from the chosen color sample.

9. appearance specification

Turn 18. The appearance specification records color, coverage, and finish together without selecting application products.

10. sample mismatch

Turn 20. The mismatch is limited to the sample's gloss, not its pink color or sheer coverage.

Return to the conversation, page 31

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which record is accurate?

C. Sheer pink, low shine, product category not yet specified.

The record preserves the three appearance details and unresolved product choice.

Return to the exercise, page 33

F2. Which question best checks coverage?

A. Do you want the nail line to show through?

Visibility of the nail line directly clarifies the desired coverage.

Return to the exercise, page 33

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Guided speaking

1. blue

Technician: The requested color is blue.

Turn 1. Blue is the chosen color family in this new scenario.

2. opaque

Client: I want opaque coverage.

Turn 2. Opaque matches the wish to conceal the underlying nail line.

3. glossy

Technician: The requested finish is glossy.

Turn 3. Glossy specifies the chosen shine independently of coverage.

4. unspecified

Reception: The product category remains unspecified.

Turn 4. The appearance request does not choose lacquer or gel polish.

Return to the conversation, page 34

03 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Sheer pink, without the shine". Dana: "Have I already booked gel polish? I don't remember choosing between that and ordinary polish on the form." Noor: [missing response] Dana: "Could you explain the difference before I choose? I don't want to agree just because I pointed to this one." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. No product category is listed. We should discuss lacquer and gel polish separately from this swatch.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Dana says: "What would opaque look like? Is that another word for dark pink, or does it mean something else?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Noor's response in turn 14. It connects Dana's preceding point with Dana's follow-up. The booking specifies neither lacquer nor gel polish, so the appearance request cannot settle that choice.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Dana says: "Then this pink is right, and the transparency is right. It's the shiny surface I'd like changed." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Dana says: "I want matte pink, like this sample. I like seeing a little of the nail through it, but I don't want it so shiny." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 34

04 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What would four decorated nails cost in total?

B. $50

Four nails at five dollars add twenty dollars to the thirty-dollar base.

Return to the exercise, page 35

A2. Which option meets the $40 limit with art?

A. Two decorated nails plus the base service

Two nails add ten dollars, making the complete total forty dollars.

Return to the exercise, page 35

A3. Which placement is selected?

A. One ring fingernail on each hand

One ring fingernail on each hand gives the agreed total of two decorated nails.

Return to the exercise, page 35

D / Response choices

D1. Which quote is complete?

A. Two decorated nails at $10 plus the $30 base: $40 total.

The correct quote states quantity, art subtotal, base price, and final total.

Return to the exercise, page 39

D2. What does one ring fingernail on each hand mean?

B. Two decorated nails in total

One selected finger on each of two hands gives two decorated nails.

Return to the exercise, page 39

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Nail included in the agreed art quantity. Which term fits?

D. decorated nail

A Not here. stripe: Long narrow decorative line or band. The usual combination is "describe a stripe".

B Not here. each hand: Separately referring to the left and right hands. The usual combination is "confirm one on each hand".

C Not here. base price: Cost of the underlying service before art additions. The usual combination is "state the base price".

D Correct. decorated nail: Nail included in the agreed art quantity. The usual combination is "count decorated nails".

Return to the exercise, page 39

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two accent nails within forty dollars". Ben: "That is more than I can spend today. Is there a smaller version that stays within forty without changing the base service?" Rosa: [missing response] Ben: "And if I decide not to have any art at all, would the base service still be available at thirty?" Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Two decorated nails would have an art subtotal of ten dollars. With the base service, the complete total would be forty dollars.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Ben says: "I had thought five dollars meant the whole design, not five for every nail. What would the four-nail version come to?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Rosa's response in turn 6. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. Art subtotal is ten dollars for two nails and must be added to the thirty-dollar base to reach the complete forty-dollar price.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Ben says: "When you say two, is that two on each hand or two altogether? I want to make sure I am counting the same way." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Ben says: "Then one on each hand sounds right. I would like the ring fingernails decorated, with the other nails left without that line design." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 39

E / Conversation

1. complete quote

Turn 2. Complete quote includes the base service and all selected art, so the client can compare the actual total with the budget.

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. per-nail charge

Turn 4. Per-nail charge applies five dollars to each of four nails, creating twenty dollars in art charges rather than one five-dollar fee.

3. art subtotal

Turn 6. Art subtotal is ten dollars for two nails and must be added to the thirty-dollar base to reach the complete forty-dollar price.

4. base price

Turn 8. Base price remains thirty dollars for the service without the optional line art, giving a second option within the client's limit.

5. quantity reduction

Turn 10. Quantity reduction is the client's explicit choice to move from four decorated nails to two, not a silent change made by the technician.

6. both hands

Turn 12. Both hands means the combined total for left and right, so two across both hands is not two on each hand.

7. accent nail

Turn 14. Accent nail is the individually decorated nail, here one ring fingernail on each hand for two in total.

8. placement

Turn 16. Placement identifies the exact nails receiving the art, which is a separate detail from the overall quantity of two.

9. budget limit

Turn 18. Budget limit is forty dollars for the entire selected service, and the confirmed option meets it with no other charges in this fictional menu.

10. design approval

Turn 20. Design approval covers the specified two ring fingernails, simple line art, and forty-dollar total, not further unrequested additions.

Return to the conversation, page 41

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which response wrongly assumes agreement?

C. I reduced your four-nail design without asking so the bill fits.

A budget constraint does not authorize silently changing the requested design quantity.

Return to the exercise, page 43

F2. Which change would exceed the accepted quantity?

B. Decorating two nails on each hand

Two per hand produces four decorated nails rather than the accepted two.

Return to the exercise, page 43

F / Guided speaking

1. two

Technician: The selected quantity is two nails.

Turn 1. One decorated nail on each of two hands gives two nails total.

2. eight

Client: The art subtotal is eight dollars.

Turn 2. Two nails multiplied by four dollars gives eight dollars for art.

3. forty-three

Technician: The complete total is forty-three dollars.

Turn 3. The thirty-five-dollar base plus eight dollars of art totals forty-three.

4. limit

Client: That total meets my budget limit.

Turn 4. The total equals the stated maximum without exceeding it.

Return to the conversation, page 44

04 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Two accent nails within forty dollars". Ben: "Then one on each hand sounds right. I would like the ring fingernails decorated, with the other nails left without that line design." Rosa: [missing response] Ben: "Yes, these two. Please leave the others plain; I like the design better on the ring fingers." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. That gives one accent nail on each hand. I will specify the two ring fingernails so the placement is not left to an assumption.

A Correct. This is Rosa's response in turn 14. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. Accent nail is the individually decorated nail, here one ring fingernail on each hand for two in total.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Ben says: "That is more than I can spend today. Is there a smaller version that stays within forty without changing the base service?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Ben says: "Good. And forty is still the complete total, not forty plus another amount for selecting those fingers?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Ben says: "I had thought five dollars meant the whole design, not five for every nail. What would the four-nail version come to?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 44

05 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What does Elena report?

C. Unexplained tenderness beside one nail

The client reports tenderness before any service, with no established cause.

Return to the exercise, page 47

A2. What happens to the covering request?

D. It is paused

Dev pauses the cosmetic request rather than covering an unexplained concern.

Return to the exercise, page 47

A3. What does referral establish?

C. A route to appropriate health assessment, not service approval

Referral addresses the health concern while cosmetic-service suitability remains a separate decision.

Return to the exercise, page 47

D / Response choices

D1. Which note stays factual?

C. Tenderness beside one nail reported before service; covering request paused.

The correct note preserves location, timing, and action without diagnosis or invented causation.

Return to the exercise, page 51

D2. Which response overpromises?

B. After the referral, we will definitely perform the requested service.

Referral does not guarantee that the salon will later approve cosmetic work.

Return to the exercise, page 51

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Visible red appearance, if actually observed or reported. Which term fits?

C. redness

A Not here. cosmetic suitability: Whether the proposed cosmetic service is appropriate after assessment. The usual combination is "assess cosmetic suitability".

B Not here. covering product: Product proposed to conceal an area or change its appearance. The usual combination is "decline to apply a covering product".

C Correct. redness: Visible red appearance, if actually observed or reported. The usual combination is "record reported redness".

D Not here. unexplained concern: Concern whose cause has not been established. The usual combination is "acknowledge an unexplained concern".

Return to the exercise, page 51

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Do not cover an unexplained concern". Elena: "It's beside this nail, not all over my hand. Can you see where I'm pointing?" Dev: [missing response] Elena: "Yes. It was there before I arrived, and nothing from today's appointment has been put on it." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. You are reporting tenderness beside this nail. I will keep that description rather than add a condition name or assume a cause.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Elena says: "So I need advice about the soreness first, and then we'd discuss whether the nail service can go ahead." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Elena says: "Who should I ask about it? I haven't had it checked, and I don't know what's causing it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 6. It connects Elena's preceding point with Elena's follow-up. Tenderness is Elena's own description of the sensation beside one nail, not a diagnosis of its cause.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Elena says: "If I get advice, can I come back for the service afterwards?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 51

E / Conversation

1. pause

Turn 2. Pause means stopping the covering request before product is applied, rather than carrying on because the client has an event.

2. event deadline

Turn 4. Event deadline explains why Elena wants a cosmetic result but does not establish that applying a product is suitable.

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

3. tenderness

Turn 6. Tenderness is Elena's own description of the sensation beside one nail, not a diagnosis of its cause.

4. pre-existing concern

Turn 8. Pre-existing concern means it was present before the proposed service, preventing an inaccurate claim that today's product application caused it.

5. healthcare professional

Turn 10. Healthcare professional identifies the appropriate route for assessing an unexplained health concern, rather than asking the nail technician to diagnose or treat it.

6. referral

Turn 12. Referral directs Elena toward appropriate health assessment; it does not itself approve the proposed cosmetic service or guarantee a later appointment.

7. Cosmetic suitability

Turn 14. Cosmetic suitability is the separate salon assessment of the proposed appearance service, not a substitute for healthcare assessment.

8. factual note

Turn 16. Factual note records the reported tenderness, its timing, the paused request, and the referral without inventing a diagnosis.

9. diagnosis

Turn 18. Diagnosis identifies a health condition through appropriate clinical assessment, which the technician has not performed or claimed.

10. service approval

Turn 20. Service approval has not been given: the covering request remains paused even though the client agrees to seek healthcare advice.

Return to the conversation, page 53

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which next step addresses the health question?

B. Assessment by an appropriate healthcare professional

The unexplained health concern needs appropriate assessment rather than cosmetic concealment.

Return to the exercise, page 55

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which distinction matters?

B. Healthcare assessment and cosmetic-service suitability are separate decisions.

The salon must separately assess the cosmetic service instead of treating referral as approval.

Return to the exercise, page 55

F / Guided speaking

1. soreness

Technician: The reported concern is soreness beside one nail.

Turn 1. Soreness is the supplied client description, not an inferred condition.

2. applied

Client: No product has been applied.

Turn 2. The scenario explicitly keeps the cosmetic application from starting.

3. paused

Technician: The covering request remains paused.

Turn 3. Referral does not restart or authorize the cosmetic service.

4. unassessed

Reception: Cosmetic suitability is still unassessed.

Turn 4. The salon must assess suitability separately from the healthcare referral.

Return to the conversation, page 56

05 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Do not cover an unexplained concern". Elena: "So I need advice about the soreness first, and then we'd discuss whether the nail service can go ahead." Dev: [missing response] Elena: "Please just note what I told you. Nobody has diagnosed it yet." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Exactly. Cosmetic suitability is not established simply by making a referral. We should not promise approval before the relevant decisions have been made.

A Correct. This is Dev's response in turn 14. It connects Elena's preceding point with Elena's follow-up. Cosmetic suitability is the separate salon assessment of the proposed appearance service, not a substitute for healthcare assessment.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Elena says: "I do not know what caused it. I was hoping the appointment could still go ahead because the event is important to me." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Elena says: "If I get advice, can I come back for the service afterwards?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Elena says: "It's beside this nail, not all over my hand. Can you see where I'm pointing?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 56

06 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. Which station is confirmed ready?

C. Station two

Rosa has confirmed station two ready through the relevant salon process.

Return to the exercise, page 57

A2. What is station three's status?

B. Tidy, with required checks incomplete

Appearance and readiness differ; station three still has incomplete required checks.

Return to the exercise, page 57

A3. What time will station three be ready?

C. No completion time is known

The case supplies no verified completion time for the pending station.

Return to the exercise, page 57

D / Response choices

D1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Two confirmed ready by Rosa; three tidy with checks incomplete.

The correct message preserves both station numbers and their different verified statuses.

Return to the exercise, page 62

D2. Which message should reception give the client?

B. A confirmed-ready station is available at station two.

Station two provides the verified option without inventing readiness for station three.

Return to the exercise, page 62

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: State of waiting for an unfinished check or decision. Which term fits?

A. pending status

A Correct. pending status: State of waiting for an unfinished check or decision. The usual combination is "keep the pending status".

B Not here. responsible technician: Person accountable for the relevant station confirmation. The usual combination is "name the responsible technician".

C Not here. reusable implement: Tool intended for repeated use subject to the required processing. The usual combination is "identify a reusable implement".

D Not here. product label: Product information including identity, instructions, and warnings. The usual combination is "consult the product label".

Return to the exercise, page 62

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Tidy is not confirmed ready". Maya: "The board says almost ready beside three. Should that say pending instead?" Owen: [missing response] Maya: "I'll change the label. Do you know how long the remaining checks will take?" Which response belongs in the gap?

D. Yes. Pending makes the status clearer. Almost ready could encourage someone else to seat a client there.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Maya says: "Then I'll leave the station pending, even if the client says they're happy to sit there." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Maya says: "Let me repeat it: two ready, confirmed by Rosa; three pending, no confirmed time. Is that everything?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Maya says: "Can I seat the waiting client at station three? The table looks clear from here." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 6. It connects Maya's preceding point with Maya's follow-up. Pending clearly indicates unfinished checks, whereas almost ready can be mistaken for permission to start.

Return to the exercise, page 62

E / Conversation

1. tidy

Turn 2. Tidy describes appearance only; station three still has incomplete required readiness checks.

2. available alternative

Turn 4. Station two is the verified alternative; using it does not change station three's unfinished status.

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

3. Pending

Turn 6. Pending clearly indicates unfinished checks, whereas almost ready can be mistaken for permission to start.

4. completion time

Turn 8. No reliable completion time is supplied for station three, so a waiting estimate would be invented.

5. confirmed ready

Turn 10. Rosa has confirmed station two through the salon process; that status cannot be transferred to station three.

6. responsible technician

Turn 12. Rosa is the named source of the station-two confirmation, avoiding an anonymous or assumed approval.

7. readiness check

Turn 14. The readiness check must cover the actual required items; surface appearance alone does not verify tools or other controls.

8. release confirmation

Turn 16. Release confirmation is the actual readiness decision after the required checks, not the client's willingness to use the station.

9. read-back

Turn 18. The read-back connects the correct station number with its status, confirmation source, and timing limit.

10. readiness handover

Turn 20. The handover gives an immediately usable option while retaining the pending station's actual status.

Return to the conversation, page 64

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. What would justify updating station three's status?

A. Completion of its required checks and the actual readiness confirmation

Readiness must follow the required process rather than appearance or scheduling pressure.

Return to the exercise, page 66

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which question is most precise?

C. Has station three received the required readiness confirmation?

The question asks about the specific unresolved status rather than a vague impression.

Return to the exercise, page 66

F / Guided speaking

1. one

Reception: The verified alternative is station one.

Turn 1. Jo has confirmed station one ready, making it the available option.

2. pending

Technician: Station five remains pending.

Turn 2. Its required checks are incomplete despite the tidy appearance.

3. Jo

Reception: The confirming technician for one is Jo.

Turn 3. Jo is the named source of the station-one readiness confirmation.

4. time

Technician: Five has no confirmed completion time.

Turn 4. The brief supplies no reliable time for station five to become ready.

Return to the conversation, page 67

06 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Tidy is not confirmed ready". Maya: "Good. Does a cleared work surface at three tell us anything about the tools that will be used there?" Owen: [missing response] Maya: "Then I'll leave the station pending, even if the client says they're happy to sit there." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. Not by itself. The readiness check follows our actual process. An empty table doesn't establish that the tools or other requirements are ready.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Maya says: "All right. For the client who's here, I'll say we have another station available now." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Maya says: "I'll offer two now and wait for an actual update before changing three on the board." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 14. It connects Maya's preceding point with Maya's follow-up. The readiness check must cover the actual required items; surface appearance alone does not verify tools or other controls.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Maya says: "Two, not three. Thanks for catching that. I'll move the client to two rather than leave them standing at reception." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 67

07 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What direction was requested and recorded?

C. Lettering facing toward the client

The service record confirms the client's original toward-client request.

Return to the exercise, page 70

A2. What is available today?

D. A no-fee review at 4:00

The available appointment is a review, not a preapproved remedy.

Return to the exercise, page 70

A3. What does no review fee mean?

D. The review itself has no charge

The fee statement applies only to the review, not unassessed additional work.

Return to the exercise, page 70

D / Response choices

D1. Which acknowledgment matches the record?

A. You requested lettering facing toward you, and that direction is recorded.

The existing service record supports the client's original toward-client direction.

Return to the exercise, page 74

D2. Which promise exceeds the supplied facts?

B. Every correction will be free and completed during the review.

Correction price, method, and completion time have not been assessed or approved.

Return to the exercise, page 74

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Oriented in the opposite direction from the named viewer. Which term fits?

C. facing away

A Not here. service record: Record of the original request and service details. The usual combination is "check the service record".

B Not here. review appointment: Meeting to examine a concern before deciding a response. The usual combination is "confirm the review appointment".

C Correct. facing away: Oriented in the opposite direction from the named viewer. The usual combination is "report lettering facing away".

D Not here. completion promise: Commitment about when work will be finished. The usual combination is "avoid an unsupported completion promise".

Return to the exercise, page 74

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "The lettering faces the wrong way". Imani: "Can Rosa look at it today? I can come back if there's an appointment." Alex: [missing response] Imani: "Would I have to pay just to come back and show her the problem?" Which response belongs in the gap?

C. She has a review appointment at four. She can look at the lettering with you and discuss what happens next.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Imani says: "And how long would I be there? I need to arrange the rest of my afternoon." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Imani says: "I see. Can you tell me how she'd change it, or does she need to see the nails first?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Alex's response in turn 6. It connects Imani's preceding point with Imani's follow-up. The available 4:00 appointment is to review the concern, not a promised completed correction.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Imani says: "Would I have to pay just to come back and show her the problem?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 74

E / Conversation

1. service record

Turn 2. The record confirms the original toward-client request, rather than a new preference after the service.

2. orientation mismatch

Turn 4. The mismatch concerns the delivered lettering direction compared with the documented request, not chipping or product wear.

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

3. review appointment

Turn 6. The available 4:00 appointment is to review the concern, not a promised completed correction.

4. review fee

Turn 8. No review fee applies to the assessment itself; it does not settle the cost of every possible remedy.

5. correction method

Turn 10. The method has not been assessed, so the receptionist should not promise a particular procedure.

6. remedy decision

Turn 12. The remedy decision follows review and agreement; accepting the appointment does not approve additional work automatically.

7. completion promise

Turn 14. A review start time does not establish when an unassessed correction could finish.

8. case note

Turn 16. The case note preserves the exact documented direction and reported result rather than a vague complaint.

9. viewing perspective

Turn 18. The client is the intended reader, which explains the toward-versus-away distinction.

10. review confirmation

Turn 20. The confirmation covers the accepted time, named technician, and no-fee review, not an approved correction or refund.

Return to the conversation, page 76

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which concern should the case note identify?

A. A lettering-orientation mismatch

The complaint concerns design direction rather than an invented health or wear issue.

Return to the exercise, page 78

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F2. Which confirmation is accurate after acceptance?

A. Today at 4:00 with Rosa for a no-fee review of the direction concern.

The confirmation states the agreed review and its limited fee scope.

Return to the exercise, page 78

F / Guided speaking

1. away

Reception: The recorded direction is away from the client.

Turn 1. Away is the documented original direction in this new case.

2. 11:00

Client: The accepted review is tomorrow at 11:00.

Turn 2. The brief gives eleven o'clock as the agreed review time.

3. fee

Reception: The review itself has no fee.

Turn 3. The no-charge statement applies specifically to the review appointment.

4. agreed

Reception: No correction method is agreed.

Turn 4. Accepting the review does not establish a particular correction plan.

Return to the conversation, page 79

07 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "The lettering faces the wrong way". Imani: "And how long would I be there? I need to arrange the rest of my afternoon." Alex: [missing response] Imani: "All right, I'll take the four o'clock review. Please make the note specific, not just unhappy with nails." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I can't make a completion promise for a correction yet. Four is the review time, not a guaranteed finish time.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Imani says: "Would I have to pay just to come back and show her the problem?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 10, after Imani says: "I see. Can you tell me how she'd change it, or does she need to see the nails first?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Alex's response in turn 14. It connects Imani's preceding point with Imani's follow-up. A review start time does not establish when an unassessed correction could finish.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Imani says: "Can Rosa look at it today? I can come back if there's an appointment." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 79

08 / Answers and explanations

A / Read the situation

A1. What appearance does the client request?

A. Plain color with no nail art

The client requests plain color and explicitly declines additional nail art.

Return to the exercise, page 80

A2. What is unknown?

D. The identity of the existing product

An existing product is reported, but its identity has not been established.

Return to the exercise, page 80

A3. What is Friday at 10:00?

C. A requested time, not a booking

The brief explicitly leaves the requested time unaccepted and unbooked.

Return to the exercise, page 80

D / Response choices

D1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Plain color, no art, Friday 10:00 requested; existing product unidentified.

The correct handover preserves appearance, timing status, and the unresolved product identity.

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D2. What must precede confirmation of removal time?

D. The consultation needed to assess the existing product and service

The brief requires consultation before a removal duration can be confirmed.

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08 / Answers and explanations / continued

D3. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Relevant record of earlier nail services and products. Which term fits?

C. service history

A Not here. file-off: Product-removal category involving controlled filing under professional procedures. The usual combination is "distinguish a file-off category".

B Not here. handover owner: Person responsible for the next action after the handover. The usual combination is "name the handover owner".

C Correct. service history: Relevant record of earlier nail services and products. The usual combination is "review service history".

D Not here. declined option: Service element the client has explicitly not selected. The usual combination is "record the declined option".

Return to the exercise, page 84

D4. Rebuild the exchange from "Friday is a request, not a booking". Sora: "Thank you. Friday at ten is the time the client requested, but we did not offer a confirmed appointment or get acceptance of a slot." Malik: [missing response] Sora: "Exactly. We also cannot assume what removal involves. The client says there is product on the nails but cannot identify it." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. Then the requested time stays requested. I will not enter it as a booking just because the client named a day and an hour.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Sora says: "I need to hand over a follow-up request. The client wants plain color next Friday at ten, but there is an existing product we have not identified." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Malik's response in turn 6. It connects Sora's preceding point with Sora's follow-up. Requested time is Friday at 10:00 as a preference, not an accepted or confirmed appointment.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Sora says: "Yes. Please offer consultation times and get the client's agreement before sending a booking confirmation." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Sora says: "Good. The client may use infill as a general word for the next visit, but we have not established whether that is appropriate here." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 84

E / Conversation

1. plain-color request

Turn 2. Plain-color request records the desired appearance without selecting a removal method, infill, or confirmed appointment.

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

2. declined option

Turn 4. Declined option is nail art, which the client explicitly excludes rather than leaving open for an unrequested design choice.

3. requested time

Turn 6. Requested time is Friday at 10:00 as a preference, not an accepted or confirmed appointment.

4. unidentified product

Turn 8. Unidentified product means material is present but its identity is unknown; it must not be recorded as no product.

5. consultation prerequisite

Turn 10. Consultation prerequisite means assessment must come before confirming removal duration or whether an infill is appropriate.

6. infill

Turn 12. Infill is a maintenance service for an existing enhancement when suitable; its name does not establish that it is appropriate for this unidentified product.

7. removal duration

Turn 14. Removal duration is the time needed for the actual service, which cannot be confirmed from an unidentified product or another client's appointment.

8. pending action

Turn 16. Pending action is the consultation availability discussion, which has not yet resulted in an accepted appointment or assessed service.

9. handover owner

Turn 18. Handover owner identifies Malik as responsible for the next discussion without claiming that the consultation or booking has already been completed.

10. client confirmation

Turn 20. Client confirmation is the explicit agreement still needed for an offered consultation appointment; a requested time alone does not provide it.

Return to the conversation, page 86

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Accuracy and scope

F1. Which phrase makes an unsupported commitment?

B. Your infill is confirmed for Friday at ten.

Neither infill suitability nor an accepted appointment is established.

Return to the exercise, page 88

F2. What does reception taking responsibility mean?

B. Reception owns the next availability discussion.

Ownership assigns the pending action without changing any unfinished assessment or booking status.

Return to the exercise, page 88

F / Guided speaking

1. Tuesday

Technician: The requested day is Tuesday.

Turn 1. Tuesday is the stated preference, not proof of an accepted appointment.

2. unidentified

Reception: Existing product remains unidentified.

Turn 2. Product is present, but its identity has not been established.

3. reception

Technician: The next availability discussion belongs to reception.

Turn 3. Reception is assigned the pending consultation discussion in the handover.

4. confirmed

Reception: Removal time cannot yet be confirmed.

Turn 4. Consultation must precede confirmation of the unassessed removal duration.

Return to the conversation, page 89

08 / Answers and explanations / continued

F / Rebuild the exchange

1. Rebuild the exchange from "Friday is a request, not a booking". Sora: "Please don't quote the usual removal time. We still don't know what we're dealing with." Malik: [missing response] Sora: "Could you read back the handover now? I want to catch any wording that makes the Friday preference sound more definite than it is." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. I will leave removal duration unconfirmed. The product and relevant service need to be understood before a meaningful time allocation is promised.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 18, after Sora says: "Yes. Please offer consultation times and get the client's agreement before sending a booking confirmation." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Sora says: "Thank you. Friday at ten is the time the client requested, but we did not offer a confirmed appointment or get acceptance of a slot." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Malik's response in turn 14. It connects Sora's preceding point with Sora's follow-up. Removal duration is the time needed for the actual service, which cannot be confirmed from an unidentified product or another client's appointment.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Sora says: "Good. The client may use infill as a general word for the next visit, but we have not established whether that is appropriate here." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 89

Review 1 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Tissue beneath the nail plate. Which term fits?

B. nail bed

A Not here. enhancement: Added material used to change nail appearance or structure. The usual combination is "clarify the enhancement".

B Correct. nail bed: Tissue beneath the nail plate. The usual combination is "distinguish nail bed and plate".

C Not here. gel polish: Light-cured color-coating category, distinct from all enhancement services. The usual combination is "distinguish gel polish".

D Not here. current length: Length present before the proposed service begins. The usual combination is "check the current length".

Return to the exercise, page 24

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Tapered shape ending in a comparatively flat tip. Which term fits?

C. coffin

A Not here. silhouette: Outer visible outline of a nail shape. The usual combination is "compare the silhouettes".

B Not here. sample display: Set of examples used to compare visible choices. The usual combination is "use the sample display".

C Correct. coffin: Tapered shape ending in a comparatively flat tip. The usual combination is "describe the coffin silhouette".

D Not here. symmetry: Visual balance between corresponding sides or nails. The usual combination is "discuss symmetry".

Return to the exercise, page 24

Review 1 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "The picture is long; the request is short". Zoe: "And the hard part I can see is the nail plate? I've heard that called the nail bed too." Lin: [missing response] Zoe: "That helps. What about builder gel and gel polish? I thought anything with gel in the name was the same service." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. The nail plate is the hard visible part. The nail bed is the tissue underneath, so those terms aren't interchangeable.

A Correct. This is Lin's response in turn 10. It connects Zoe's preceding point with Zoe's follow-up. The plate is the hard visible nail; the nail bed is the tissue beneath it.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Zoe says: "Please keep that short-length request on the booking. I don't want the picture confusing anyone else who helps today." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Zoe says: "Yes, that's right. I want the look discussed, not the long length copied." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Zoe says: "Yes, that's what I meant. I heard someone call it a full set and assumed that was the right name." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

4. Rebuild the exchange from "A shape that fits the working day". Amara: "Good. Please keep the softened corners in the discussion too. That is part of what I like about the second sample." Kai: [missing response] Amara: "Yes, short with those softer corners. Let's check the actual length together." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I will. Softened corners are part of the visible shape you prefer, separate from the exact length we still need to confirm.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Amara says: "Does squoval mean it won't break? A friend told me it was the strongest shape." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Kai's response in turn 18. It connects Amara's preceding point with Amara's follow-up. Softened corners distinguish the chosen squoval appearance from a more sharply square outline in this comparison.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Amara says: "Yes. I like the tapered shape, but that length would make typing awkward for me." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 8, after Amara says: "I think the shorter one is closer. Could we use that shape without copying the long sample?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 24

Review 2 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Basic color family, such as pink or red. Which term fits?

A. hue

A Correct. hue: Basic color family, such as pink or red. The usual combination is "describe the hue".

B Not here. top coat: Finishing coating whose properties depend on the product system. The usual combination is "discuss the top coat".

C Not here. opaque: Concealing the underlying nail rather than allowing it to show through. The usual combination is "distinguish opaque coverage".

D Not here. satin: Soft-sheen appearance between matte and high gloss in a given range. The usual combination is "compare a satin finish".

Return to the exercise, page 45

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Repeated or distinct decorative element. Which term fits?

A. motif

A Correct. motif: Repeated or distinct decorative element. The usual combination is "choose a motif".

B Not here. nail art: Decorative design added to the nail appearance. The usual combination is "specify the nail art".

C Not here. ombre: Gradual visual transition between colors or tones. The usual combination is "describe an ombre effect".

D Not here. smile line: Curved boundary between a contrasting French tip and the rest of the nail design. The usual combination is "describe a crisp smile line".

Return to the exercise, page 45

Review 2 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "A shape that fits the working day". Amara: "The shorter one seems less likely to get in my way. Does that mean it will definitely be comfortable when I type?" Kai: [missing response] Amara: "Does squoval mean it won't break? A friend told me it was the strongest shape." Which response belongs in the gap?

B. I cannot give a comfort guarantee from a sample. Your work needs help guide the consultation, but they do not prove how a particular result will feel on your actual nails.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Amara says: "Yes, short with those softer corners. Let's check the actual length together." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Correct. This is Kai's response in turn 10. It connects Amara's preceding point with Amara's follow-up. Comfort guarantee would promise a daily-use outcome that the sample alone cannot establish for this client.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Amara says: "How short do you mean on my nails? Could you show me before you start?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Amara says: "I like this almond sample, but it looks much longer than I could manage at work. I spend most of the day using a keyboard." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 45

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "Two accent nails within forty dollars". Ben: "Good. And forty is still the complete total, not forty plus another amount for selecting those fingers?" Rosa: [missing response] Ben: "That's agreed: both ring fingernails, forty dollars altogether. No extra art today." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. Correct. Your budget limit is met by this option. There are no other charges in this comparison, and the two-nail art total remains ten dollars.

A Correct. This is Rosa's response in turn 18. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. Budget limit is forty dollars for the entire selected service, and the confirmed option meets it with no other charges in this fictional menu.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Ben says: "Then one on each hand sounds right. I would like the ring fingernails decorated, with the other nails left without that line design." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Ben says: "I had thought five dollars meant the whole design, not five for every nail. What would the four-nail version come to?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 2, after Ben says: "I would like the simple line design on four nails, but I need to keep the whole appointment at forty dollars. Does that work?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 45

Review 3 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Skin beside the nail or another specified area. Which term fits?

B. adjacent skin

A Not here. treatment advice: Recommendation intended to address a health condition. The usual combination is "avoid unsupported treatment advice".

B Correct. adjacent skin: Skin beside the nail or another specified area. The usual combination is "describe adjacent skin".

C Not here. cosmetic request: Request to alter appearance, distinct from healthcare treatment. The usual combination is "pause the cosmetic request".

D Not here. sensitivity: Reported heightened response to touch or a substance. The usual combination is "clarify reported sensitivity".

Return to the exercise, page 68

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Item intended for one use under its instructions. Which term fits?

D. single-use item

A Not here. personal protective equipment: Equipment used to reduce exposure to workplace hazards. The usual combination is "confirm required personal protective equipment".

B Not here. used-item area: Designated place for items awaiting the required handling. The usual combination is "identify the used-item area".

C Not here. station: Designated work area for a client service. The usual combination is "identify the station".

D Correct. single-use item: Item intended for one use under its instructions. The usual combination is "identify a single-use item".

Return to the exercise, page 68

Review 3 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Two accent nails within forty dollars". Ben: "Let's do two with the line design, then. I can manage forty, but not fifty today." Rosa: [missing response] Ben: "When you say two, is that two on each hand or two altogether? I want to make sure I am counting the same way." Which response belongs in the gap?

D. I will confirm that quantity reduction with you: two decorated nails instead of four, for forty dollars in total.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Ben says: "That is more than I can spend today. Is there a smaller version that stays within forty without changing the base service?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Ben says: "Yes, these two. Please leave the others plain; I like the design better on the ring fingers." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Ben says: "When you say two, is that two on each hand or two altogether? I want to make sure I am counting the same way." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Correct. This is Rosa's response in turn 10. It connects Ben's preceding point with Ben's follow-up. Quantity reduction is the client's explicit choice to move from four decorated nails to two, not a silent change made by the technician.

Return to the exercise, page 68

4. Rebuild the exchange from "Tidy is not confirmed ready". Maya: "Let me repeat it: two ready, confirmed by Rosa; three pending, no confirmed time. Is that everything?" Owen: [missing response] Maya: "I'll offer two now and wait for an actual update before changing three on the board." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. That's an accurate read-back. It should prevent the ready label ending up beside the wrong station.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 16, after Maya says: "Then I'll leave the station pending, even if the client says they're happy to sit there." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Maya says: "Who confirmed two? I'd like to put the name in the note so the next receptionist can see it." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 18. It connects Maya's preceding point with Maya's follow-up. The read-back connects the correct station number with its status, confirmation source, and timing limit.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Maya says: "The board says almost ready beside three. Should that say pending instead?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 68

Review 4 / Explanations

Cumulative review

1. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Oriented so the relevant front faces the named viewer. Which term fits?

A. facing toward

A Correct. facing toward: Oriented so the relevant front faces the named viewer. The usual combination is "confirm lettering facing toward the client".

B Not here. wear concern: Report about how the result has changed during use. The usual combination is "record a wear concern".

C Not here. refund approval: Authorized decision to return money. The usual combination is "distinguish refund approval".

D Not here. design brief: Agreed description of the requested decoration. The usual combination is "refer to the design brief".

Return to the exercise, page 90

2. A colleague needs the term for this meaning: Product-removal category used for materials designed for the relevant solvent process. Which term fits?

C. soak-off

A Not here. consultation prerequisite: Consultation needed before confirming further service details. The usual combination is "explain the consultation prerequisite".

B Not here. maintenance appointment: Follow-up service whose scope depends on assessment. The usual combination is "clarify the maintenance appointment".

C Correct. soak-off: Product-removal category used for materials designed for the relevant solvent process. The usual combination is "clarify a soak-off category".

D Not here. existing product: Material already on the client's nails before a new service. The usual combination is "identify the existing product".

Return to the exercise, page 90

Review 4 / Explanations / continued

3. Rebuild the exchange from "Tidy is not confirmed ready". Maya: "All right. For the client who's here, I'll say we have another station available now." Owen: [missing response] Maya: "Who confirmed two? I'd like to put the name in the note so the next receptionist can see it." Which response belongs in the gap?

C. That works. Station two is confirmed ready; we don't need to give the client a detailed account of the unfinished checks elsewhere.

A Not here. This line belongs to turn 20, after Maya says: "I'll offer two now and wait for an actual update before changing three on the board." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 4, after Maya says: "Two, not three. Thanks for catching that. I'll move the client to two rather than leave them standing at reception." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Correct. This is Owen's response in turn 10. It connects Maya's preceding point with Maya's follow-up. Rosa has confirmed station two through the salon process; that status cannot be transferred to station three.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Maya says: "Good. Does a cleared work surface at three tell us anything about the tools that will be used there?" It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 90

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4. Rebuild the exchange from "Friday is a request, not a booking". Sora: "Yes. Please offer consultation times and get the client's agreement before sending a booking confirmation." Malik: [missing response] Sora: "Thanks. Explain that we need to check the existing material so we can plan the right appointment." Which response belongs in the gap?

A. I will be the handover owner for the availability discussion. Taking responsibility does not change the unbooked status or resolve the product uncertainty.

A Correct. This is Malik's response in turn 18. It connects Sora's preceding point with Sora's follow-up. Handover owner identifies Malik as responsible for the next discussion without claiming that the consultation or booking has already been completed.

B Not here. This line belongs to turn 12, after Sora says: "Good. The client may use infill as a general word for the next visit, but we have not established whether that is appropriate here." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

C Not here. This line belongs to turn 14, after Sora says: "Please don't quote the usual removal time. We still don't know what we're dealing with." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

D Not here. This line belongs to turn 6, after Sora says: "Thank you. Friday at ten is the time the client requested, but we did not offer a confirmed appointment or get acceptance of a slot." It addresses that point, not the missing turn in the supplied exchange.

Return to the exercise, page 90

Additional case 1 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. input rating

Turn 2. The 36 W input rating concerns electrical power; matching it does not establish that lamp B meets system G's curing requirements.

2. compatibility

Turn 4. Compatibility between the exact lamp and product system is unverified; a shared input rating cannot supply the missing evidence.

3. model identity

Turn 6. Model identity names the actual lamp; a similar case or display does not make two models interchangeable.

4. timer

Turn 8. The timer shows elapsed or selected time, not proof that an unspecified lamp supplies the required light conditions.

5. surface

Turn 10. The surface appearance does not independently verify curing throughout the product or replace the specified system instructions.

6. UV-free

Turn 12. UV-free cannot be inferred from LED; nail-curing LED systems may emit ultraviolet light.

Return to the conversation, page 93

Transfer exchange

1. M2

Technician: The lamp named by system H is M2 .

Turn 1. M2 is specified in the supplied instructions; a larger electrical rating does not change that identity.

Additional case 1 / Explanations / continued

2. M9

Lead: The available but unverified model is M9 .

Turn 2. M9 is the proposed substitute, not the documented required lamp.

3. rating

Technician: Forty-eight watts is the substitute's input rating .

Turn 3. The input rating describes electrical power, not verified compatibility or the curing conditions at the nail.

4. unverified

Lead: Compatibility with H remains unverified .

Turn 4. No supporting evidence is supplied, so neither the wattage nor availability approves substitution.

Return to the conversation, page 95

Additional case 2 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. disinfection

Turn 2. Disinfection is a required process completed for A after cleaning; the cleaned-only label on B does not establish it.

2. cleaned only

Turn 4. Cleaned only means that stage is recorded for B; the remaining required processing and confirmation are not complete.

3. storage

Turn 6. The supplied UV cabinet is for storage only; placing tools inside cannot replace the required disinfection process.

4. cross-contamination

Turn 8. Cross-contamination can transfer unwanted material or microorganisms between used and prepared items; separate handling preserves the distinction.

5. single-use

Turn 10. Single-use describes the intended use limit; an unworn appearance does not make the used board reusable.

6. Sterilization

Turn 12. Sterilization is a distinct validated process, including elimination of bacterial spores; no such process is established by this record.

Return to the conversation, page 97

Transfer exchange

1. F

Technician: The only confirmed-ready set is F .

Turn 1. F has completed all stated requirements; neither used D nor cleaned-only E has that status.

Additional case 2 / Explanations / continued

2. only

Assistant: Set E is cleaned only .

Turn 2. Only limits the completed stage and prevents an unsupported readiness claim.

3. disposal

Technician: The used single-use file follows the disposal procedure.

Turn 3. Its single-use designation excludes the reusable-tool processing route in this case.

4. storage

Assistant: The cabinet provides storage, not the missing processing.

Turn 4. The supplied cabinet is for storage only and cannot establish disinfection or sterilization.

Return to the conversation, page 99

Additional case 3 / Explanations

Extended conversation

1. smile line

Turn 2. The smile line is the curved boundary separating the contrasting tip from the pink area in sample A.

2. ombre

Turn 4. Ombre is a gradual blended transition; Sol instead chooses the crisp division shown in sample A.

3. reverse French

Turn 6. The label here identifies the base-crescent design in B; the specified location, not the label alone, settles the request.

4. ring fingernails

Turn 8. The ring fingernails receive B instead of A; one on each hand gives two accent nails.

5. eight

Turn 10. Ten fingernails minus the two ring-finger exceptions leaves eight receiving sample A.

6. placement map

Turn 12. A placement map assigns the chosen design to specific nails, preventing a correct count from landing on the wrong fingers.

Return to the conversation, page 101

Transfer exchange

1. seven

Technician: Sample A appears on seven nails.

Turn 1. Ten nails minus three exceptions leaves seven for A.

Additional case 3 / Explanations / continued

2. three

Client: Sample B replaces A on three nails.

Turn 2. The left thumb, right index, and right middle are three distinct nails.

3. left thumb

Technician: The single exception on the left is the left thumb .

Turn 3. The brief assigns B to the left thumb, not a left ring or index finger.

4. right hand

Client: The index and middle exceptions are on my right hand .

Turn 4. Both of those named exceptions are on the client's right, not the technician's right.

Return to the conversation, page 103

Find a phrase by purpose

Clarifying the service and the intended length

Clarify the label: When you say full set, do you mean added length?

Ask about the result: Would you like to keep your current length?

Refer to the booking: Your booking currently says overlay.

Full phrase bank, page 7

Comparing shape and practical length

Ask about daily use: What length feels practical for your keyboard work?

Acknowledge the attraction: You like the almond outline in this sample.

Identify the conflict: This particular almond sample is longer than your stated preference.

Full phrase bank, page 17

Explaining color, coverage, and finish

Separate the choices: Let us check color, coverage, and finish one at a time.

Confirm the color: Pink is the color you prefer.

Ask about visibility: Do you want the natural nail line to remain visible?

Full phrase bank, page 29

Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote

Ask about the limit: Is $40 your total budget, including the base service?

State the base price: The base service is $30.

Explain the unit charge: Simple line art is $5 per decorated nail.

Full phrase bank, page 38

Find a phrase by purpose / continued

Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns

Acknowledge the concern: Thank you for telling me about the tenderness.

Clarify the location: You are describing the area beside this nail.

State the timing: This was reported before any service began.

Full phrase bank, page 50

Giving a clear station-readiness update

Identify the station: Station three is the one still awaiting checks.

Describe only what is known: It looks tidy, but its required checks are incomplete.

Avoid an appearance shortcut: Tidiness does not establish confirmed readiness.

Full phrase bank, page 61

Handling a chip or design concern

Acknowledge the detail: You requested the lettering facing toward you.

Use the record: The service record confirms that direction.

Describe the concern: You are reporting that the finished lettering faces away.

Full phrase bank, page 73

Scheduling follow-up and handing over exact requests

Open the handover: I have a plain-color request with an unidentified existing product.

State the appearance: The client wants plain color and no nail art.

Record the requested slot: Friday at 10:00 is the preferred time.

Full phrase bank, page 83

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References and publication notes

All cases, organizations, figures, and conversations are fictional teaching material, not transcripts. Communication practice does not replace qualified advice or current workplace procedures.

[1] US Food and Drug Administration. Nail Care Products.

Background for product directions, warnings, and the distinction between cosmetic services and treatment of health problems. No medical or chemical procedure is taught. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.fda.gov/cosmetics/cosmetic-products/nail-care-products

[2] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Health Hazards in Nail Salons.

Context for chemical, biological, and ergonomic concerns and the need for actual workplace checks. The readiness dialogue does not supply disinfection instructions. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.osha.gov/nail-salons

[3] OPI. How to Shape Nails.

Manufacturer vocabulary for visible shape distinctions such as almond, square, and squoval. The book compares appearances and does not reproduce shaping steps or durability claims. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.opi.com/blog/nail-care/how-to-shape-nails

[4] Creative Nail Design. Troubleshooting and FAQs: PLEXIGEL Q&A.

The linked manufacturer FAQ distinguishes enhancement uses and product-dependent removal. This book teaches terminology without endorsing a product or reproducing application instructions. Source checked 10 October 2026.

https://www.cnd.com/pages/troubleshooting-faqs

Companion course

The website offers the eight-lesson course and related practice. This book can be used independently. No audio access or external account is needed for its exercises.

https://englishladder.com/efsp-nail-technicians.html

Precise details. Clear agreement.

Eight lessons on consultations, shapes, finishes, quotes, concerns, station updates, and bookings. Three additional conversations cover curing-system checks, tool turnover, and precise nail-art placement.

Clarifying the service and the intended length

Overlay is a broad coating term, and full set can be used loosely. In this conversation, the client wants a natural-nail overlay at the current short length, with no extensions requested. Confirm the result before relying on either label.

Comparing shape and practical length

This comparison concerns the two supplied samples: long almond and short squoval. Squoval describes an outline, not an absolute length in every salon. The selected short appearance still needs an agreed length reference and normal assessment.

Explaining color, coverage, and finish

Matte and sheer answer different questions. Matte concerns shine; sheer concerns how much underlying nail remains visible. The client can request both. The glossy swatch illustrates the preferred color and coverage, not the agreed final shine.

Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote

Four decorated nails cost $20 in art charges, making $50 with the base service. Two decorated nails cost $10 in art charges, making $40 total. Two on each hand would be four in total and exceed the stated budget.

Phil Stilwell

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